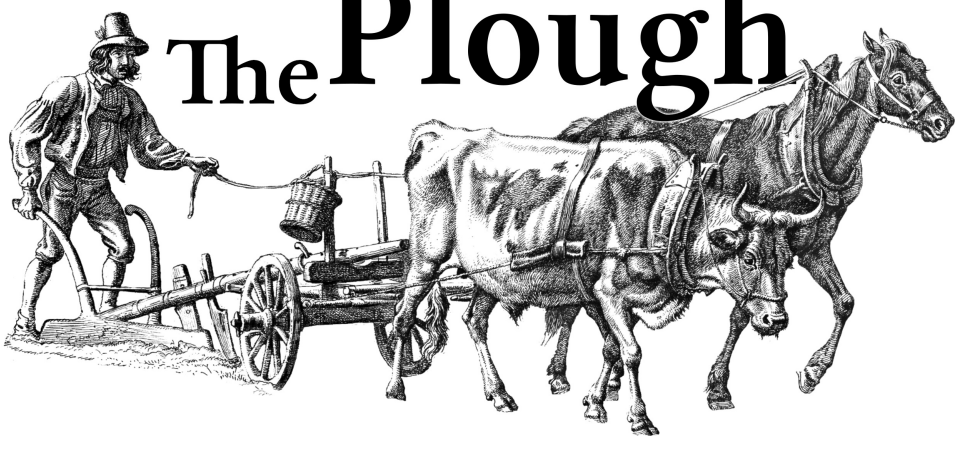


The Plough

NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

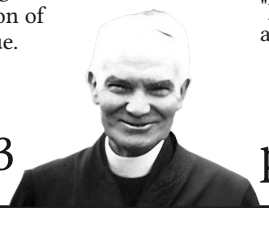
Issue October 2026

Featuring

On The Virtue of Patriotism: Part I

Fr E. Cahill SJ

Is patriotism a virtue? Or is it a holdover from a bygone time? Fr Edward Cahill disagrees and declares that Christians have no right to ignore the cultivation of this virtue.

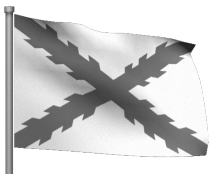


pg. 3

The Traditional Mass and Carlism, a Paradox

Carmen Giménez

Our author challenges the mantra that the layman's job is simply to "pay, pray, and obey".

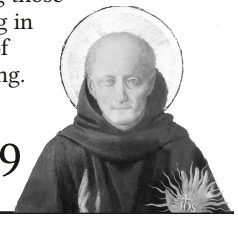


pg. 7

Backbiters Get Their Due

St Bernadine of Siena

With a passion, precision and righteousness unkown to our modern ears, St Bernadine delivers a public sermon rebuking those engaging in the sin of backbiting.



pg. 9

King Alfred of England

Our Catholic Heritage in English Literature

Emily Hickey

King Alfred was one of the great Anglo-Saxon kings of England prior to the Norman Invasion of 1066. He was a devout man who greatly loved his people: he wanted to incorporate the best of Roman civilization into his realm while upholding their proud heritage as Englishmen. As Anglophone Catholics, we need reminding that our forefathers were great and that our heritage is Catholic. Published in 1910 from Our Catholic Heritage in English Literature of Pre-Conquest Days.

"Let us praise the men of renown," says Holy Scripture (Ecclesiasticus, 44), "and our fathers in their generations…. Such as have borne rule in their dominions, men of great power and endued with their wisdom … ruling over the present people, and by the strength of wisdom instructing the people in most holy words."

We have to think now of a man of renown who bore rule in his dominions; a man of great power, and endued with wisdom; who by strength and wisdom instructed his people in most holy words. We have hitherto spoken of work done in the dedicated life of religion: to-day we direct our attention to the work of a great layman; the first English layman whom we know to have been a great power in literature; less as a "maker," poet or proseman, than as an opener out to "makers" of precious store; a helper and encourager; a fellow-student; a learner and a teacher of whom it could be said, as Chaucer says of his Clerk of Oxford, "gladly would he learn and gladly teach."

It would not, I think, be possible for English people to over-estimate the value of the gift God gave them in King Aelfred. That is really the right way to spell his name, but as to most people it looks unfamiliar, we will adopt the more usual spelling and write of him as Alfred.

We think of him in various aspects: first as the strong, brave man who did so much toward making noble history for time to come, by his own action, guided by his piety and devotion. His earliest work was to fight for the gaining of freedom and unity for his people, and this work went over many years. When there was an interval of peace, and when a more settled peace had been won, he worked hard to gain for them the freedom of the mind which can never exist where ignorance is reigning. Freedom is the first great possession; afterwards we seek for learning and culture. People who may be called away at any moment to fight for life or liberty cannot do much in the way of quiet study; and while the Danes were not yet finally repulsed or bound by treaty, the great work of Alfred in civilizing England had to remain in suspense.

We love to think that Alfred's wars were not to greaten himself, but to set his country free. Then, as later on, if I may quote what I have elsewhere said, the English:

> Had fought for their God-given birthright, their country to have and to hold, And not for the lust of conquest, and not for the hunger of gold. There is another aspect in which we may look at this great King; we think of him not only as a doer but as a sufferer; and not only as an endurer of disappointment, a bearer of toil, difficulty, trouble, but as one who bore in his body a "white martyrdom" of great pain, perhaps even anguish; and this for some twenty years.

Alfred was always a loyal son of the Church. His father, Æthelwulf, sent him to Rome when he was quite a little boy, and Pope Leo IV was godfather to him at his Confirmation, and, on hearing the report of Æthelwulf's death, consecrated him as king, as he had been asked to do. But Æthelwulf did not die for a little time after, and took Alfred for a second visit to Rome. Each of Alfred's three brothers reigned a short time before he became King of Wessex in 871. In that same year he fought no fewer than nine battles against the Danes, besides making sundry raids upon them. It is well to be a good fighting man where need is, and it is well to use the qualities that go to the making up of the good fighting man to meet the difficulties that beset the path of duty and the way of progress. Courage, strength, generosity, perseverance, these are needed for all work alike in peace and war.

Alfred was familiar in his youth with English songs, and most probably knew the old Norse sagas; but he had to learn Latin in his later life. We must remember that most of the literature which Alfred could get at was locked up in Latin; even the invaluable Church History of St Bede needed a translator's key; and it was Alfred who first applied this key to it.

When we think of the prose written in England in early days, we are thinking of the work of scholars, in a grand language that had done growing; a language that was to be in Western Christendom the language of religion, the language of the altar, for how long a time who can know? The language that gave birth to other languages, as its literature so powerfully influenced both theirs and that of others not descended from it. Not yet was the time for a great prose literature in England, such as grew up many a year ago, and is going on in our own days.

The earliest literature of a people is almost invariably in verse: the literature that comes from the heart of a people, and is not the production of a few learned folk. In early days, there was little reading or writing, except in the shelter of the great monasteries. The common folk-literature, which is a very precious thing, is preserved, in such times as we are thinking of, in people's memories, and circulated by recitation, this recitation being accompanied by music or by rhythmical movements of the body. We all know how much easier it is to remember a page of verse than a page of prose. Thus, the form that could most easily be carried in the memory and recited, would naturally be the first to flourish.

We have seen something of early English religious poetry in Caedmon's work and that of his followers; and next we shall come back to poetry with Cynewulf, who made great and holy verse.

But beside such work as these poems which were written by cultivated men, many poems and fragments of verse were floating about the land, come over from the old native country with the first Angles and Saxons who made their home in Britain. These were dear to the people and dear, as we shall see, to the greatest among their kings, Alfred, who was, we may say, the founder of English prose. It was not English prose as we know English prose, because the language was then more like German than anything else; but it was prose in the native tongue, and this was a good and great thing to begin.

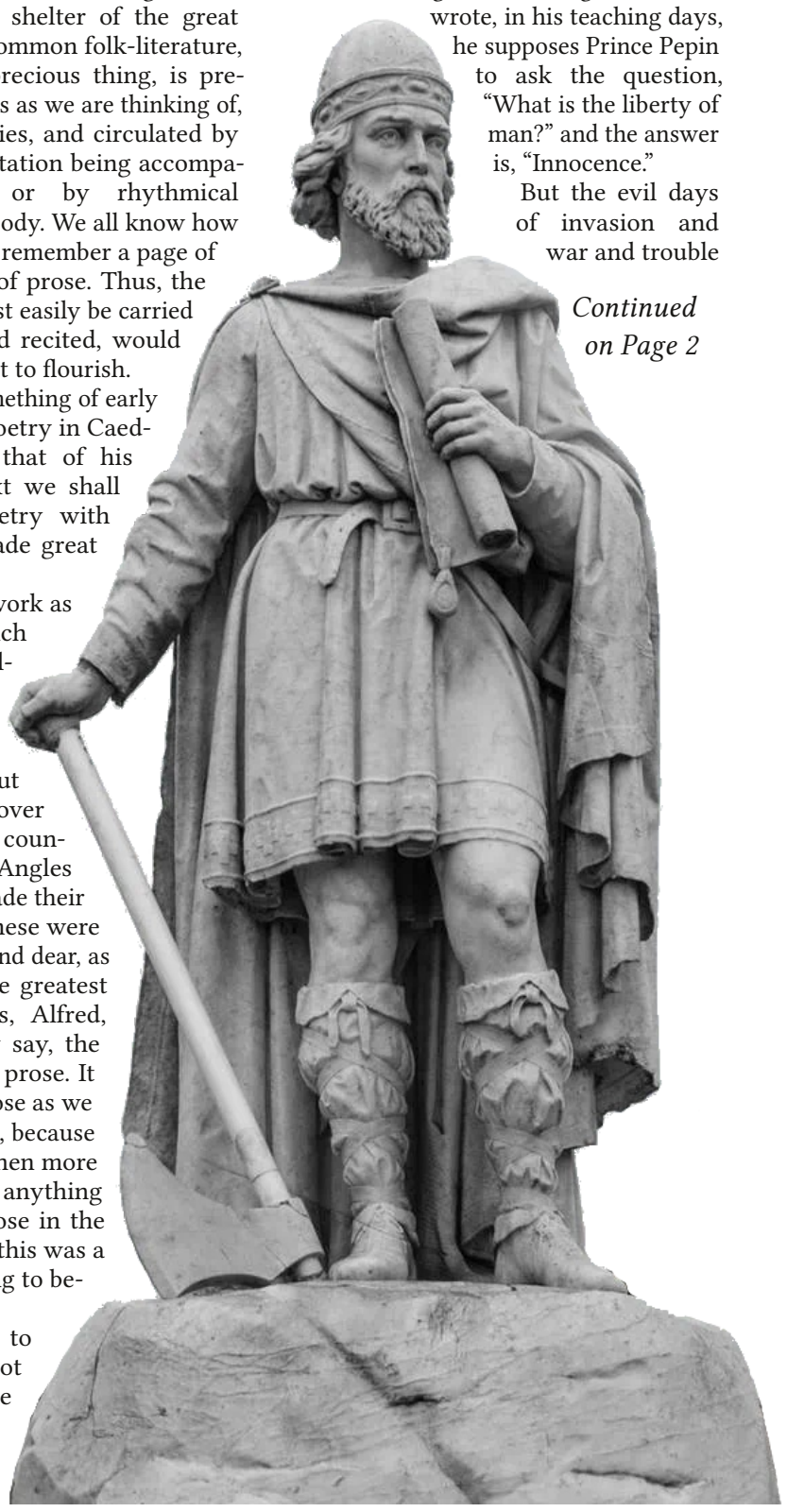
In our gratitude to Alfred, we must not forget our gratitude to the English scholars of older days, none of whom had put us under so great a debt as our dear old Benedictine of Jarrow.

A later writer than St Bede, though not so great as he, was Alcuin of York, who was invited by no less a man than Charlemagne to teach his children, and who became, as it has been phrased, a sort of Minister of Public Education in his empire.

Alcuin was good as well as great, and I will give you a little instance of the rightness of his thought. In a Dialogue which he wrote, in his teaching days, he supposes Prince Pepin to ask the question, "What is the liberty of man?" and the answer is, "Innocence."

But the evil days of invasion and war and trouble

Continued on Page 2



King Alfred of England Cont.

Continued from Page 1

had swept learning from its northern home; and Alfred's work was to bring it back to another part of England.

We cannot forget the impression that must have been made upon Alfred by his stay in Rome, young as he was at the time, he being in the centre of royal state while there, and also being himself a royal child to whom much would be told and under whose notice much would be brought; and who, from his position, would be expected to mark and remember much. Long afterwards, he would recall the magnificence he had seen, and associate it with the glories of the double history of Rome; Rome pagan and Rome Christian: Rome, the great conqueror and law-giver, spiritual as well as temporal. Very often, after Alfred was king, he sent over embassies and gifts to Rome, loving her, and reverencing her as it was meet he should. The Holy Father granted him certain privileges for the English school at Rome, and sent him a piece of the wood of the Holy Cross.

There is a pretty story told of Alfred's early learning to read English verse. Even if it is not true, it points to his love of English, as well as learning; a love which never left him. He wanted English to be taught in schools, and he loved the old poems. We owe to him the translation of the account of the first English poet, Caedmon. But rightly, he felt the very great importance of learning Latin, and so he learned it himself, and made others learn it too.

When Alfred came to the throne, he tells us, learning had fallen away so utterly in England that there were very few of the clergy, on the south side of the Humber, who could understand the Latin of their Mass-books, and he thinks not many beyond the Humber. This state of things was very different from that of old times when the clergy were "so keen about both teaching and learning and all the services they owed to God": very different from St Bede's time, and the days when Northumbria was a centre of learning and culture. Alfred was to create a new centre, not in the North but in Wessex. Later on, the centre of learning and cultivation was shifted to the East Midlands, whose dialect became the language of England, and whose great poet, Chaucer, was the greatest English poet before Spenser and Shakespeare.



The Alfred Jewel: discovered in 1693, it is a fine example of Anglo-Saxon jewellery. Its provenance is guaranteed: it was inscribed with "AELFRED MEC HEHT GEWYRCAN" meaning "Alfred ordered me made".

In his studies Alfred was helped by various friends, the chief of whom was a Welsh Bishop, named Asser. So greatly did Alfred value Asser that he wanted him to live altogether at Court; but Asser felt, it is to be supposed, that this would not be right, and arranged to spend half his time in Wales and half with the King. From him we learn a great deal about Alfred.

One of the Latin books translated by Alfred—perhaps the first—was called the "Pastoral Care" ("Cura Pastoralis"). It was written by St Gregory the Great, and was intended for the clergy as a guide to their duties. The king had a copy sent to every bishopric. He called it the Herdsman's Book, or Shepherd's Book. Sending all these copies made of course a great deal of work for scribes or "bookers," as we may render the old "bóceras," the copyists who had to write out all their books by hand.

As various books had been turned into the "own tongue" of various nations, so would Alfred give to his people in their "own tongue" books of help, of knowledge, of wisdom. This is how Alfred tells us he worked:

> "I began to turn into English the book which in Latin is named 'Pastoralis,' and in English 'Shepherd's Book'; sometimes word for word, sometimes meaning for meaning, as I had learned it from Plegmund, my Archbishop, and Asser my Bishop, and from Grimbold, my Mass-priest, and from John, my Mass-priest."

At the end of the translation, Alfred put some little verses of his own.

Alfred as we have seen, translated St Bede's History, omitting many chapters which contained things he may be supposed to have thought were not of general interest. He also edited the English, usually called the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, which begins with the invasion of Julius Caesar, and ends with the accession of Henry II. There are a good many manuscripts of it, the earliest of which ends with the year 855. We owe this work, as we owe so much beside, to the care of the monks who wrote it, adding to it probably, year by year, sometimes giving poetry as well as prose. It contains several poems, among them the vigorous lay of the Battle of Brunanburh, fought in 937 by Athelstane against the Scots and Danes. You will find a rendering of it among Tennyson's poems, made by him from a prose translation of his son's. This editing of the A.S. Chronicle was very important work, work that has helped generations of history-writers and students. Where should we be without these Histories? How much of it Alfred actually did himself we do not know: we may suppose he had a good deal to do with the chronicling of the events of his own reign. I wonder whether it was he that wrote how three bold Irishmen came over from Ireland in a boat without any rudder, having stolen away from their country, "because they desired for the love of God to be in a state of pilgrimage, they recked not where." They had a boat made of "two hides and a half," and provisions for a week. They got to Cornwall on the seventh day, and soon after went to Alfred. We have no account of their visit to the King, but I think he would have welcomed them right warmly, and loved to hear how big souls ride in little cockleshells. We know their names at least: Dubslane, Macbeth, and Maclinnuim. And immediately after this record we are told something that must also in a different way have greatly interested Alfred. "And Swifneh, the best teacher among the Scots (Irish) died."

Another book that Alfred translated was the History written by a Spanish priest called Orosius, a disciple of St Augustine's (of Hippo), which "was looked upon as a standard book of universal history." Alfred by no means gave a literal translation, but used great freedom, and omitted some things and put in others which he judged of greater interest and importance for Englishmen. Alfred enlarged the account of Northern Europe, which he knew a great deal of. He also added the accounts of the voyages of Ohthere and Wulfstan, the former of whom got round the north of Scandinavia and explored the White Sea. Wulfstan's voyage also was of importance. Both these men told Alfred their stories, and he incorporated them in the History. They came to see him, and Ohthere gave him teeth of the walrus, and no doubt Alfred listened to all they told him, with the keenest interest.

"The account of Ohthere's voyage holds a unique position as the first attempt to give expression to the spirit of discovery."

Alfred knew how to use helpers. All who understand the "ought to be" take help as well as give it. The good King encouraged others, and the office of encourager is no mean part of the office of helper. We cannot do our work in the world alone: God meant us to work with others, and man's best work as an individual can never be independent of the work of others, those who are living or those who have gone before.

Another of the books translated by Alfred was the "Consolations of Philosophy," by a good and thoughtful Consul of Rome, who was put to death by Theodoric, the Arian King of the East Goths. He wrote the book in prison, and there was so much in it that was felt to be in accord with Christian teaching that some people thought Boethius must have belonged to the body of Holy Church.

"In his studies Alfred was helped by various friends, the chief of whom was a Welsh Bishop, named Asser."

A Christian writer, finding a book seeming to possess much of the spirit of Christianity, would naturally study it and frequently use it; and Boethius's book, with more or less adaptation, grew to be a great favourite with Christians. Its influence can be traced in the work of the greatest Catholic poet, Dante, and in that of the great English poet, Chaucer, who rendered it into the English of his day.

Alfred made the translation definitely Christian. For instance, he writes of "God" and "Christ" where Boethius says "love" or "the good"; and he writes of "angels" instead of "divine substance."

I will give you one or two specimens of the additions to Boethius with which Alfred is credited.

"He that will have eternal riches, let him build the house of his mind on the footstone of lowliness; not on the highest hill where the raging wind of trouble blows, or the rain of measureless anxiety."

"Power is never a good unless he be good who has it."

Here is what he has to say of being well-born:

"Art thou more fair for other men's fairness? A man will not be the better because he had a well-born father, if he himself is nought. The only thing which is good in noble descent is this, that it makes men ashamed of being worse than their elders, and strive to do better than they."

And here is his standard of self-respect:

"We under-worth ourselves when we love that which is lower than ourselves."

These sayings are worth copying into a little book such as Alfred kept to note down things he wanted to keep track of. Asser tells us this, and he tells us of the "Handbook" which grew to a great size, from this collecting habit of Alfred's. The book was unfortunately lost.

By no means have we exhausted the interest of Alfred's story. It would be indeed difficult to do so; but we must now bid him good-bye.

We love to think how, amidst all his cares and work for his kingdom, he had the true Catholic Missionary spirit; for he sent embassies to India, with alms for "the Christians of St Thomas and St Bartholomew."

There is a valuable thing which we possess, known as the "Alfred Jewel": it has on it an inscription which we can truly say applies to far more than this work of art. Its application to Alfred's work is indeed a very wide one: "Alfred commanded to make me."

October 10: St Francis Borgia

Lives of the Saints

Alban Butler

From Butler's Lives of the Saints, *Benziger Brothers Edition.*

Francis Borgia, Duke of Gandia and Captain-General of Catalonia, was one of the handsomest, richest, and most honored nobles in Spain, when, in 1539, there was laid upon him the sad duty of escorting the remains of his sovereign, Queen Isabella, to the royal burying-place at Granada. The coffin had to be opened for him that he might verify the body before it was placed in the tomb, and so foul a sight met his eyes that he vowed never again to serve a sovereign who could suffer so base a change. It was some years before he could follow the call of his Lord; at length he entered the Society of Jesus to cut himself off from any chance of dignity or preferment. But his Order chose him to be its head. The Turks were threatening Christendom, and St. Pius V sent his nephew to gather Christian princes into a league for its defense. The holy Pope chose Francis to accompany him, and, worn out though he was, the Saint obeyed at once. The fatigues of the embassy exhausted what little life was left. St. Francis died on his return to Rome, October 10, 1572.

Reflection: St. Francis Borgia learned the worthlessness of earthly greatness at the funeral of Queen Isabella. Do the deaths of friends teach us aught about ourselves?

On The Virtue of Patriotism: Part I

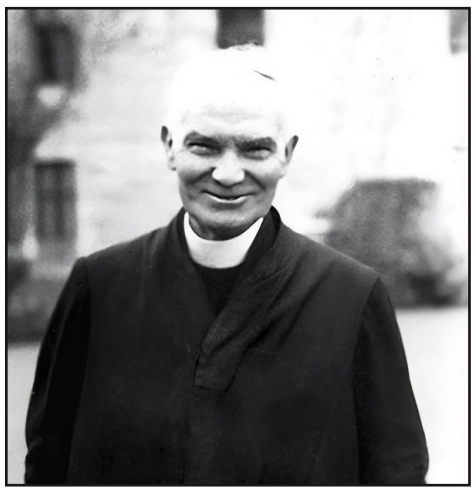
Framework of a Christian State

Fr E. Cahill SJ

Published in 1932, this work of Fr E. Cahill of Ireland gives a comprehensive introduction to how a Christian State might organise itself, and what those organising principles actually are. Framework of a Christian State *includes many read-worthy chapters, including the one one on patriotism presented here. This virtue is very much misunderstood today and is under great attack by revolutionary forces. Similar to how one cannot choose their family, one cannot choose their nation: but nonetheless, if we are to act perfectly as Christians, we are called to reserve a special love for those of our nation—those who are like us—over the foreigner: not at the expense of charity but in the perfect fulfillment of it.*

Introduction

Relations of Patriotism to Justice and Charity.—We have said that while Justice is the main element in well-ordered civic life, it has to be supplemented by other forces, of which Charity and Patriotism are the chief. Patriotism fulfils a function in the social organism not unlike what we have already ascribed to Charity. Within its own sphere it supplements Justice, facilitating and perfecting the activities of the latter, and constantly urging one on to acts of benevolence and self-sacrifice far beyond the limits of what Justice or any other virtue could impose under strict obligation. Patriotism, however, is much more restricted than Charity in the range of objects to which it refers, bearing somewhat the same relation to Legal and Distributive Justice as Charity does to Commutative Justice. For while Charity includes within its scope one's relations to all men, as Commutative Justice does, Patriotism, like Legal and Distributive Justice, refers to one's fellow-countrymen alone; and just as these latter virtues, having to do only with men's civic relations, are not quite so essential for the well-being of society as Commutative Justice, which regulates all of men's dealings with one another, so also Patriotism is not so fundamental or far-reaching in its influence upon man's social life as Charity, which is the Queen of the Virtues. This is probably one of the reasons why St. Thomas and the other great Catholic theologians, while laying down clearly enough the principles which underlie the virtues of Legal and Distributive Justice and of Patriotism, do not treat these virtues with the same fulness of detail as Charity and Commutative Justice receive.



Fr Edward Cahill

Its Special Importance at the Present Day.—Nevertheless, Patriotism, as well as Legal and Distributive Justice, have very important functions to fulfil in social life. Owing to the special needs of modern society and the enhanced importance of all civic relations, these virtues are now receiving more attention from Catholic writers than formerly. For the same unchristian social reformers, especially those identified with extreme Liberalism and Revolutionary Communism, who would disintegrate the family, and abrogate the privileges and reasonable autonomy of the local and professional units within the State, concentrating in a bureaucracy all civic and even domestic authority, deny also the virtue of Patriotism. They reject and repudiate national and civic ties and obligations as being opposed to their false theories of humanitarianism and internationalism, or the so-called "Solidarity of Labour." In place of the natural and traditional virtue of devotion to one's own country they wish to substitute a colourless and ineffective love of humanity and a so-called "Patriotism of the world," or "International Patriotism."

Again, Pius XI speaking of another section of these opponents of the Christian virtue of Patriotism, those, namely, who are identified with the forces of international finance, writes:

"As regards the relations of peoples among themselves, a double stream has issued from this one fountain-head: on the one hand economic Nationalism, or even economic Imperialism; on the other, a not less noxious and detestable Internationalism or international Imperialism in financial affairs, which hold that where a man's fortune is, there is his country."

Division of Subject.—In the present sketch we shall treat first of the nature and foundation of the virtue of Patriotism; secondly, of its place in the Christian law, and finally, of its practical applications in social life.

Father F. X. Godts, C.S.S.R., addressed to the clergy of Belgium on the best means of dealing with the present social evils, insists strongly on the essential need of inculcating the love of country on the children. "Just as the nature of God," he writes, "is charity or love, so that of Socialism is hatred—hatred towards the earthly country ... whose very name they desire to blot out; hatred especially towards the heavenly country, the hope and knowledge of which they are striving to filch away from the unhappy labourers in this land of exile. Hence, the Socialists reject the national flag which each country has made its own; and they adopt instead a red flag, the symbol of death and destruction. Hence, too, they take the name of 'Internationalists,' boasting that they have no country and no fellow-countrymen... . Their unholy doctrine is as much opposed to nature as it is to religion."

The Virtue of Patriotism

Instinctive Love of Country.—Love of the environment and society amidst which one has been born and grown up is founded upon natural tendencies and needs, and, like parental affection and filial love, it exists as an unreasoning instinct, even in the lower animals. As man's upbringing and growth take a longer time than the growth of the lower animals, and include the development of mind and will, as well as of bodily organism, this natural tendency is, perhaps, stronger and more deeply rooted in men than in other creatures. Just as parents gladly sacrifice their own interests and ease for the future well-being of their children, so men willingly labour and suffer for the future safety and prosperity of their country. They grieve, too, over the evils which they foresee may overtake it after they themselves have passed away, and they find consolation in its future welfare and happiness.

> "Furthermore, and of still greater importance for the interests of the human race, the natural love of country assists the due relations of social life."

"Nature," writes a well-known seventeenth century author, "has implanted so deeply the love of country in the hearts of men, that... we cannot restrain our thoughts from turning fondly and continually to the concerns of the fatherland. Like the sun-flower, which constantly looks towards the sun, turning with him every hour of the day, even when the clouds obscure his rays, so are we all impelled by an instinct of nature to centre all the affections of our souls on the land that gave us birth."

The natural love of the surroundings of one's childhood includes in its object not only the material place, its scenery and climate, but still more the persons associated with these, the civic institutions, the language and traditions with which one's early years have been familiarised, and which must have played each its part in shaping one's character and tastes. This instinctive love, like all other natural tendencies, comes from the Author of nature, who is God, and so must in itself be good and useful to the human race.

Its Utility for Social Well-being.—This natural love of country acts upon a man as a kind of magnetic force, tending to retain him in his own country, and if he is absent to recall him to it. Without some such force there would be a perpetual flow of the human race towards the more temperate climes and the more fertile lands, with the result that the more barren as well as the excessively hot and cold portions of the globe would be deserted, to the great detriment of the human race. It seems to be a law of man's nature that neither harshness of climate nor barrenness of soil, nor the fact that he suffers hardships or persecution in his native land lessens his love for it.

Furthermore, and of still greater importance for the interests of the human race,

Continued on Page 4

Facing Fate

Young Man of Character

Bishop Tihamer Toth

From Bishop Tihamer Toth's Young Man of Character.

It can be said of every great man: "He knew how to will!" Saint Thomas Aquinas was asked by his own sister: "What shall I do to gain eternal life?" "You have to will to gain it" was the brief answer.

It does not befit a young man to be cast down before difficulties and complications; he should rather face them bravely. Even if the sky is overcast, the sun will come out eventually. No matter how severe the winter is, spring is on its way.

The young one must never be dispirited. Work is for the young, rest is for the old. Do not be afraid! Face the difficulties boldly! Often the problems appear worse than they really are. There is an English saying: "It is not raining as hard as it looks through the window."

Read how wisely the pagan Seneca thought about this matter:

Misfortune does not break the strong man. (Prov. 2)

Calamity is virtue's opportunity. (Prov. 4, 6)

Fire tests gold; trouble tries the strong man. (Prov. 5, 8)

The history of great men is full of rousing examples. Many thought everything was their sworn enemy. Thousands of obstacles were in the way of their plans, but they faced them, and won.

The Calvary of Christopher Columbus lasted eighteen years in the royal courts of Europe, until finally he could start preparing his sea voyage. Do you know how old he was at this point? Fifty-eight. Others retire at that age; he was only allowed to get started at this age. Beethoven, the great composer, was deaf when writing his greatest masterpiece. Moses, the great liberator of the Israelites, had a speech impediment, but humbly accepting his fault, with the help of God, he became the great leader of Israel.

So do not be a pessimist! Do not say: "No matter what I start, it will not work out, I am pursued by misfortune." Do not say, as so many do, "If one is lucky, even his bullock will have calves, and if he is out of luck, he will always break his nose." If you think that misfortune is pursuing you, turn around and stare it down.

Do not say "the blockhead is the pet of fortune." This saying is the comfort of the lazy and the helpless, implying that he, on the other hand, is very clever. Trying to blame others, not ourselves, for our troubles is always vanity.

Listen, how the lazy boy is whining when a diligent boy receives a good mark: "Of course! Yesterday they sent a big ham to the teacher. If only we had a spare ham..." But he would never admit that he is lazy and the other one is diligent.

Listen to what a storekeeper says about another: "The man has no skin on his face. He is not averse to stealing and cheating..." But he would never admit that the other is more diligent, more skillful than he; that the other is getting ahead not with his sins but with his virtues: his zeal to work, his skills, his indefatigability, his foresight; and he himself is left behind because he is clumsy, loves his comforts, is not thrifty enough, and neglects his business.

On The Virtue of Patriotism: Part I Cont.

Continued from Page 3

the natural love of country assists the due relations of social life. Just as the natural love between husband and wife and between parents and children facilitates the mutual co-operation of the members of the family, so also the love of country, by closely uniting the families and individuals of a nation in bonds of a common affection and common ideals promotes the harmonious and efficient working of the State. Thus, when controlled and guided by right reason, this instinctive love of country becomes the foundation of a moral virtue.

Virtue of Patriotism—A Portion of Piety.—The virtue of Patriotism is a branch or subdivision of Piety. Piety is the virtue which inclines one to render due honour and service to those who are the source of one's being, and the agents or authors of one's upbringing and education. Now, since God is the primary source of man's being and of all the good he has, the first duties of piety are towards God. These duties, however, by reason of their transcendent excellence, are usually classed apart, under the special name of Religion, and the term Piety is confined to one's obligations towards those who are the secondary or immediate source of one's being and education. Principal among these are one's parents and the country or civil society amid which one was born and brought up.

"Our parents and our country," writes St. Thomas, "are the sources of our being and education (gubernationis). It is they that have given us birth and nurtured us in our infant years. Consequently, after his duties towards God, man owes most to his parents and his country. One's duties towards one's parents include one's obligations towards relatives, because these latter have sprung from [or are connected by ties of blood with] one's parents... and the services due to one's country have for their object all one's fellow-countrymen and all the friends of one's fatherland."

Hence, obligations of piety extend in due proportion, directly or indirectly, to parents, relatives, fellow-countrymen, and to all persons closely connected with these. For the present we are concerned only with that branch of piety which refers to one's countrymen, and which is called Patriotism.

Patriotism may be defined as the virtue which inclines one to love and serve the country to which one belongs. The existence of the strong natural instinct already described, which God has implanted so deeply in the human heart, goes far to show that man is bound by the natural law to love and serve the civil society with which he is naturally identified, just as he is bound to love and, when necessary, to assist his parents and his own immediate family.

Moral Relations of the Part with the Whole.—Besides the ties of origin upon which the virtue of Patriotism primarily rests, there are other kindred relations between a citizen and his country to which St. Thomas frequently refers, in connection with the civic virtues (Virtutes Politica), which later he identifies, at least partially, with the virtue of Patriotism. His doctrine is briefly this: The part tends instinctively to seek the good of the whole to which it naturally belongs, rather than its own. This tendency, which belongs to all creatures, points unmistakably, in the case of rational beings, to a dictate of the natural law, and hence it may be taken as the guide in determining the citizen's duty of service to his country. For, the State is, or may be, a natural whole of which citizens or members are the parts.

"The tendencies of nature [he writes] are perceived in actions which are done without deliberation... . Now, we see that every part strives spontaneously and according to natural inclination to procure the good of the whole, even at the cost of its own peril or loss. Thus, a person exposes his hand to the sword-cut to defend his head, for upon the latter the safety of the whole body depends. Hence, it is a tendency of nature that each part should in its own way love the whole to which it belongs more than itself. Consequently, it is in accordance with the dictates of social virtue that a good citizen should expose himself to death for the common good."

In another passage St. Thomas explains that the whole, for whose good the part has a natural inclination to sacrifice itself, must be a natural whole, one, namely, founded upon natural ties, as distinct from artificial arrangement, or mere positive law.

"Everything [he writes] that by its nature and being is a part of another has a stronger and more deeply-rooted inclination in favour of the whole to which it belongs than of itself... And since reason copies nature, we find such an imitation in the civic virtues. For it is the duty of a good citizen to expose himself to the danger of death for the safety of the whole State. And if the citizen be a natural part of the State, this tendency would be natural to him."

One's birth and education in a certain family, and in the midst of a particular society, together with all the associations that accompany or result from these facts, are the usual foundation of the natural union of which there is question here. But even in after life quasi-natural ties may arise, as when an immigrant becomes by long association, practically identified with the civil society into which he has been adopted.

"Fellow-citizens," writes Cicero, "have many things in common, their places of public assembly, their temples, their public halls, their highways; they have the same constitutions, the same laws, the same courts of Justice. They vote according to the same system, follow the same social customs, and have numberless bonds of friendship, of interest and of business dealing."

It is clear, however, from what we have already explained of the natural foundations of the virtue of Patriotism that when all natural and quasi-natural ties are wanting, one cannot have duties of Patriotism towards a State, although duties of Legal Justice and of Charity may exist.

The Civic Union a Natural Society.—Seeing that the virtue of Patriotism rests essentially upon natural civic ties, it will be well to analyse more fully the meaning of these later. According to the ordinary Catholic teaching the State or Nation is a natural society. This means, according to the designs of Providence as manifested in human nature, man is meant to live as a member of an organised civil union, the purpose of which is to assist the members to attain temporal happiness. The general structure, functions and powers of the civil union are determined by the natural law; just as the same natural law determines the functions of the matrimonial union and the general nature of the marriage contract. It does not, however, follow that the natural law directly ordains that any particular group of families and individuals are bound together into one nation or State.

The formation of the State depends upon certain contingent facts, given which there arises a natural inclination or need for these families and individuals to coalesce into an organised State. When the natural tendency is strong, permanent, and clearly defined, and when its realisation will not interfere with the rights of any other group, or with any vital interest of the community at large, it is clearly a dictate of the law of nature, which ordains that men should enjoy reasonable freedom in pursuing their own happiness, that no outside individual or group should prevent such a natural inclination from being gratified. Moreover, no *fait accompli*, resulting from coercive force, can of itself justify override or invalidate such a fundamental right. The case is to a certain extent on a par with a man's natural right to choose his own partner in life. When a young man and woman have a desire, founded perhaps upon natural sympathy or mutual suitability, to get married, no one has a right to interfere, at least as long as there exists no legal impediment, and the just claims of no third party will be violated by the union.

The Natural Civic Ties.—That sets of historical facts and concrete circumstances may in actual fact bind together certain groups of individuals, families and social units into a naturally constituted whole united with one another by ties closely connected with the virtue of Patriotism, few will seriously deny, except under the influence of political prejudice. If, as a result of the great European war (1914–18), Germany were to have forcibly annexed France, or Holland, or England, to the German Empire, disregarding all the cherished aspirations of the people, their historical traditions, their natural sympathies, their racial characteristics and antipathies, their just and reasonable national pride, the action would be unjust, and would be condemned by all as a gross violation of the natural and divine law. The continued enforcement of such a union would still remain unjust, even after the first victims of the wrong had passed away. If the time ever came when such a union would cease to be unjust and unnatural, that could only be when the natural bonds of union, such as the racial characteristics of the nations concerned, their sympathies and antipathies, and their reasonable national aspirations, had in the evolution of time become so altered that these countries could no longer be regarded as distinct natural units, different from the German nation. It is only in such a sense that prescriptive titles can heal the original injustice of a forcible conquest or annexation.

"Among the natural ties usually enumerated are: ... unity of race, a common language, a similarity of customs, identical national aspirations, a certain community of economic interests; and, most important of all, a participation in common historical memories and associations."

Although most authorities agree in asserting the existence of natural civic ties, even Catholic writers are not always at one in specifying exactly what these ties are; and still greater differences of opinion sometimes exist in the application of the general principles to concrete cases. Is such a group to be regarded as a distinct nation or not? Granted that such another group was once a separate nation, has it now, as a result of changed circumstances, lost its national individuality? The former question may arise in regard to such groups as the Flemish or the Basques of Northern Spain, the latter concerning groups like the Welsh or the Scotch.

Among the natural ties usually enumerated are: a certain unity or convenient contiguity of territory, unity of race, a common language, a similarity of customs, identical national aspirations, a certain community of economic interests; and, most important of all, a participation in common historical memories and associations. Such an enumeration, however, must be regarded as only indicating in a general way the main constituents of the national unit. How far any one or more of the conditions named is to be considered essential to the idea of nationhood, or how far the absence of some may be counterbalanced by the presence of others in a more intense degree, it would be impossible to determine in the abstract. Each case must be examined separately. The element of size has also to be considered; for the unit should be large enough to constitute an independent and self-sufficing State; and this again has to be judged in the light of several other circumstances. Thus, in ancient and mediaeval times, a single city, with a moderate amount of surrounding territory, might more easily form an independent economic unit than it could to-day, when increased facilities of intercommunication, intensified economic activity and the custom of mass production require larger bodies of producers and consumers and a much more complex organisation.

The consent or wishes of the people, whether essential or not in itself as a constituent part of the ties that go to make a natural unit, is evidently the strongest and most important indication of the actual presence or absence of those ties. For no people will persevere in wishing and striving after a certain political ideal unless the latter is founded upon natural requirements.

The Subject of Patriotism.—

to be continued



Feast day in Latvia: social life is made all the more possible by the bonds of love within a nation.

Evolutionism and Teilhardism: Part I

Modern Temptations

Paulinus

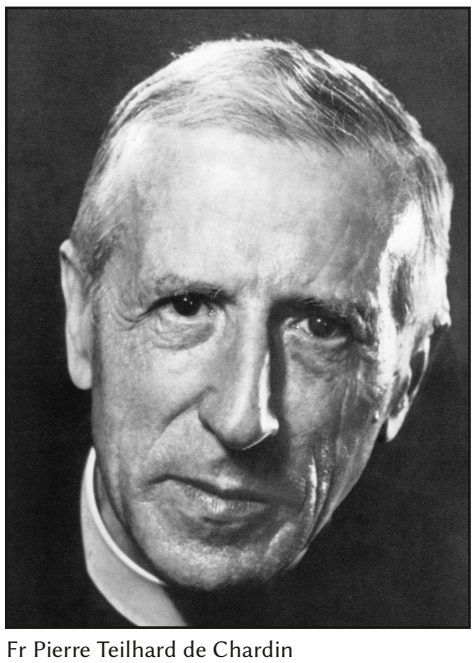
From Si Si No No *published in 1998. This was a popular Italian language Catholic periodical whose orthodoxy was unquestionable even up into the end of the 20th century. Our author writes on the revolution amongst some of the clergy on the reinterpretation of Holy Scripture. During the 20th century, elements within the Church did open battle: trading blows by means of the various committees and arms of the government of the Church. What is the Catholic mind?*

Modernist Temptations

The renowned geneticist Giuseppi Sermonti wrote:

Modernist temptations are dangerous. You risk accepting modernity just at the time when it is found to be in its death throes, and, for the love of the world, becoming followers of Darwin just as Darwinism is on the wane. You risk establishing the moral law on the theory of man's evolution from monkeys, when this theory has been henceforth refuted (*Il Tempo* on July 10, 1987).[1]

The above quotation seems to have taken on the marks of a prophecy today, ten years later, when we read the commentaries on John Paul II's "Message" to the "Pontifical Academy of Sciences"[2] in the journal *La Nazione*: "Faith and Science: Satisfaction for the Pope's words, which have served to give a facelift to Darwin's pet but still unproven theory—soul or no soul, thanks to the monkey."[3]



Fr Pierre Teilhard de Chardin

As far as Darwin's theory is concerned, *La Nazione's* writer exaggerates, since that theory makes no exception for the soul, which must also be considered to be a product of evolution. It is, however, quite certain that John Paul II's "Message" is indeed disconcerting for many reasons.

Two Discourses: Based on the Magisterium?

We read in John Paul II's "Message":

I am quite pleased with the first theme which you have chosen, that of the origin of life as well as that of evolution. [...] Before giving you a few more specific thoughts on this theme, I would like you to remember the fact that the Magisterium of the Church has already pronounced itself on these themes, and in the limits of its own competence, to be sure. I will now quote two addresses (documents).

Then the Pope quotes Pius XII's encyclical *Humani Generis* which does mention evolutionism; as well as his own speech (Oct. 31, 1992) to that same Academy of Sciences—an address in which no mention is made of evolutionism, but of...Galileo and biblical exegesis.

We read in John Paul II's "Message":

As for me, while receiving (October 31, 1992) those taking part in the plenary assembly of your Academy, I had the opportunity, speaking of Galileo, of bringing their attention to the need for the correct interpretation of the inspired Word of God, of the strictest observation of hermeneutics. We must properly define the true meaning of Holy Scriptures while brushing aside those faulty interpretations which are wont to make them say that which they are not meant to say. In order to encompass as well as possible the field of the object of their study, the exegetes, as well as the theologians, must continually keep themselves informed of those results provided by the natural sciences (cf. AAS85, 1993, pp.761-772; Address to the Pontifical Biblical Commission, April 23, 1993, which preceded the later document on "the interpretation of the Bible in the Church" (AAS86, 1994, pp.232-243)).

One preliminary observation: Since it is a question of evolutionism, it would have been more to the point to remind the scientists of the limitations of natural science rather than the exegetes' and theologians' duty of keeping themselves informed about those "findings (which are certainly not infallible) coming from the various natural sciences." This is especially true in view of the fact that, in this matter, exegetes as well as theologians have already let themselves be over-imposed upon by some presumed "findings" (simple hypotheses, in reality) of "sciences of nature," which have been strongly influenced—let us not forget—by a philosophy based on atheism.

And then Holy Scriptures, of which we would do well to "properly define the true meaning," are—to put it plainly—those first chapters of the Book of Genesis wherein are revealed the origins of mankind. The above-mentioned "reminder" of the necessity of the "strictest observance of hermeneutics" is tantamount to saying, therefore, that up to the present day, we have not yet been given "a correct interpretation" of Genesis and that the sacred texts have been twisted to say "that which they are not meant to say" regarding the creation of mankind. Besides, the passing reference to the "document on 'the interpretation of the Bible in the Church'" that toxic fruit of the new Pontifical Biblical Commission, simply boils down to saying: *a)* that this new "correct interpretation" of Genesis must now come to us through the new "Pontifical Biblical Commission" whose members are to distinguish themselves "by their Catholic sensitiveness,"[4] but are, quite on the contrary, regularly

> "This new and finally 'correct' interpretation of the Book of Genesis should spring from that method falsely called 'historico-critical method,' which simply reduces Genesis to a mythological tale."

chosen from amongst the most notorious of new-modernist exegetes;[5] *b)* that this new and finally "correct" interpretation of the Book of Genesis should spring from that method falsely called "historico-critical method," which simply reduces Genesis to a mythological tale, a method conspicuously supported in the above-mentioned document: "The interpretation of the Bible in the Church."[6]

Fortunately, Card. Ratzinger, in the preface to this document, makes it clear that the "historico-critical method" (in actual fact, that same criticism corning out of the Protestant-rationalist mold) is still being hotly debated and, above all, that the new Pontifical Biblical Commission "is in no way to be considered an organ of the Magisterium" (as, on the contrary, was the previous Biblical Commission). It is, therefore, in any case, and for many reasons, quite inexact to speak of "two discourses" of the "Church's Magisterium" on the themes of evolution and the origin of life. The one and only public address of the Magisterium on this question is and remains even today, Pope Pius XII's *Humani Generis*, which, however, cannot be considered the final and definitive pronouncement on this theme.

On the other hand, we may well say that the Magisterium of the Church has indeed already pronounced itself "with two official discourses" on the "correct interpretation" of Genesis:

1) With the Decree (June 30, 1909) of the Pontifical Biblical Commission, which was, at that time, an "organ of the Magisterium," a decree whereby it was guaranteed that the literal-historical sense [*i.e.,* meaning] of the first three chapters of the Book of Gen-

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On Confession

The Medicinal Sacrament

Fr Bede Jarrett

From his work Meditations for Layfolk, *published in 1915.*

The State has set up courts of justice, the Church courts of mercy. The State in the name of justice punishes, the Church in the name of mercy forgives. The whole apparatus of the civil law is intended to track down the criminal, to follow the traces of his work, and discover his identity. It gives him, indeed, every possible means of escape in the sense that it affords him opportunity for proving his innocence, or establishing such an explanation of his action as should procure his release. He has an impartial judge who probably has not heard his name ever before mentioned. His jury is presupposed to be altogether uninfluenced by personal motives, so that he can actually challenge and reject every member of it whom he may consider to have a personal antagonism to himself; and his counsel may be offered him at the expense of the State. The whole boast of the law is that it is utterly impartial, the unfaltering judge, the deliberating jury, the legal accuser of the advocates. But parallel with this, and intended as the result of the whole organization, is the action of justice, a strict rendering to each one of what is his due: punishment to the guilty, acquittal to the innocent. The confession of the criminal would not ordinarily affect his penalty at all, so that the plea of "not guilty" is almost always put forward so as to throw the whole burden of proof on the shoulders of the law.

But the Church has no such ideas, does not at all contemplate the action of justice. To trace the criminal, to confront him with witnesses, to twist his evidence from improbability to sober fact, is to violate the seal of secrecy and to commit a crime so rare that the annals of Church History have to be ransacked to find even a doubtful occurrence of it. There is never any attempt at any such thing. It is a principle laid down for the guidance of priests that the penitents must be believed when they accuse or excuse themselves. Hence the very personality of the culprit is shrouded in the hushed whisper, the free choice of the confessor, the rigorous suppression of all details of place and name that would be likely to lead to the confessor's knowledge of the people implicated. The penitent may desire to unburden himself to the priest, but the priest himself cannot force him to do so. Even if he does happen to recognize him, he will not remember outside what he has learnt within. This shows the different methods pursued by Church and State, the different purposes of mercy and justice. Perhaps some will declare that confession does really achieve more justice than do the courts of law; but such is not the intention of the Church. She seeks only after mercy, waiting for the penitent to come that she may listen and by God's power forgive.

Confession, then, is the tribunal of mercy. I go to it, perhaps shrinking from the avowal of my misdeeds, not because I have done anything particularly shameful (though this would almost necessarily add to the effort required), but from the very disinclination of telling another of my hidden faults. It offends my humanity; really it offends my pride, for it is difficult for man to beg for mercy, even from God. It is really that which makes confession so hard to me; to ask for mercy seems contrary to all the self-respect that makes man rise to the heights of his nature. Had he to stand and receive a punishment in some sort adequate to his failure, it might be easier because it is more heroic; but to have to beg for forgiveness is an achievement which only Christianity has been able to produce in the nobler souls of her children. To recount my tiresome and petty delinquencies is harder to flesh and blood in some ways than to make avowal of a deliberate act of passion. Yet it is the mercy of God which alone can bring me to my knees and make me ask for my forgiveness; and this mercy I must regard as a high privilege, something which adds to and in no way lessens the value of human dignity. On Him must my eyes be fixed so that even my sins are remembered, not for my own humiliation, but for His tender love. I go to seek His mercy, not simply because I love Him, but far more because He loves me; not because to err is human, but because to forgive is Divine.

Evolutionism and Teilhardism: Part I Cont.

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esis cannot in any way be questioned (*i.e.*, doubted) when it is a matter of facts concerning or affecting the very foundations of the Christian Faith; including...the particular creation of man and the formation of the first woman from the first man.[7]

2) With Pope Pius XII's *Humani Generis*, which upholds the historicity [i.e. the historical authenticity] of the first eleven chapters of Genesis against the neo-modernists of the "new theology," while reaffirming the value and merits of the following decree of the Pontifical Biblical Commission:

> The first eleven chapters of the Book of Genesis, although, properly speaking, not conforming to the historical method used by the best Greek and Latin writers or by competent authors of our time, do nevertheless pertain to history in a true sense.

Now the dastardly deed of handing over the "correct interpretation" of Genesis to the so-called "historico-critical method" which, in casting off into the trashpile the Catholic doctrine on the inspiration and absolute inerrancy [*i.e.*, infallibility] of Sacred Scriptures, has in effect, simply buried Catholic exegesis while even denying the historicity of the Holy Gospels. All of which means establishing, in the Catholic Church itself, that mythological interpretation according to which Genesis is to be considered just a fabulous tale, and so there is really nothing to be found in Holy Scriptures on the origin of mankind.

A Little Too Much and a Bit Too little

In John Paul II's "Message," the following is said concerning Pius XII's encyclical:

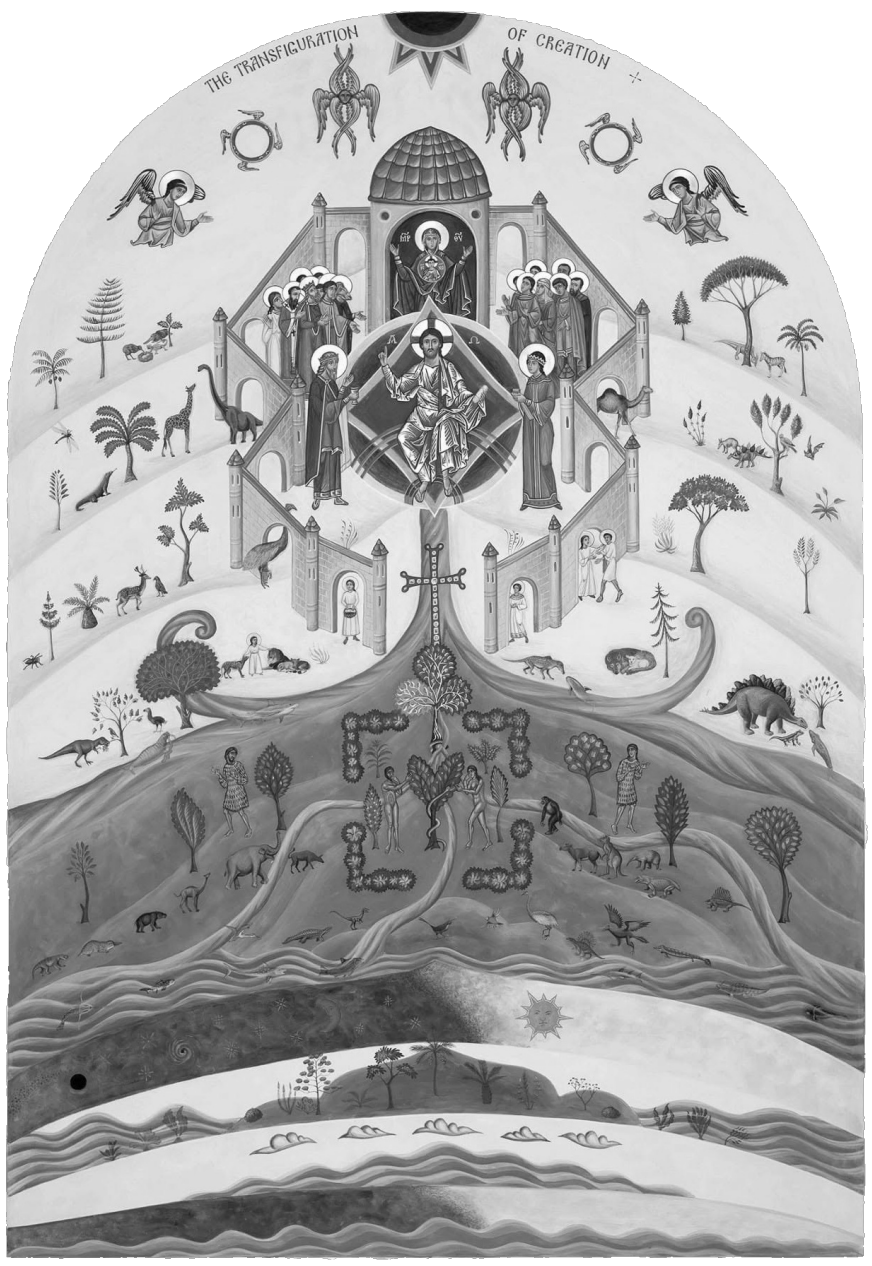
> In his encyclical *Humani Generis* (1950), my predecessor Pius XII had already declared that there was no opposition between evolution and the doctrine of Faith concerning man and his vocation, providing that certain basic points be kept well in mind (cf. AAS42, 1950, pp.575-576)

In view of the state of scientific research of those earlier days and also taking into account the particular requirements of Catholic theology, the encyclical *Humani Generis* considered the doctrine of evolutionism as a serious hypothesis, worthy of research and of serious thought and this, just as much as its opposing hypothesis. Pius XII added two methodological conditions: that this opinion be not adopted as though it were a certain and demonstrated doctrine and as if Revelation could be completely disregarded in questions of this nature. He also mentioned the necessary proviso that this opinion be compatible with the Catholic Faith, a point upon which I shall return.

Today, nearly 50 years after that Encyclical, new knowledge leads us to no longer consider the theory of evolution as just a simple hypothesis. [...] Pius XII had underscored this essential point: if the human body takes [*sic*] its origin from living, pre-existent matter, the spiritual soul is immediately created by God (*animas enim a Deo immediate creari catholica fides nos retinere iubet*, Encyclical *Humani Generis* AAS, 42,1950, p.575).

Frankly, it seems that John Paul II's message makes Pius XII say a little too much on the one hand, and a bit too little on the other.

A little too much, because Pius XII in *Humani Generis* is distinctly speaking of two evolutionisms. Of the first he writes:



The Seven Days of Creation: Beginning from the bottom and crowned with Our Lord at the top.

Whoever closely observes those outside of Christ's fold will easily and soon discover the main paths travelled by a great number of scientists. In fact, they are the very ones who make out that the so-called system of evolution can be applied to the origin of everything; now, the proofs of this system are in no way irrefutable, even in the limited field of natural science. They do, however, accept it without any prudence whatsoever, without proper judgment, and we hear them professing smugly and brashly that monist and pantheist hypothesis of some primeval and unique 'something' completely and fatally subject to a never-ending evolution. Now, this is very precisely the very same postulate adopted by the partisans of communism so that, when the souls of men have been deprived of every idea of a personal God, they may the more efficaciously defend and propagate their dialectical materialism.

The above quotation constitutes in simple terms the (Church's) official condemnation of evolution, be it materialistic, atheistic or pantheistic: all of which deny the dogma of creation. In his message, John Paul II unfortunately neglects to recall the above-mentioned condemnation of Pius XII, and it is this omission which has probably prompted those screaming headlines about Darwin's unmerited rehabilitation as was done in the previously-mentioned newspaper *La Nazione*.

If atheistic and materialistic evolutionism was running rampant "outside the Christian fold" at the time of Pius XII, the so-called theistic evolutionism was, indeed, already prevailing inside the fold of Christ. Since this last type of evolutionism admits God's influence upon evolution and the direct creation of the human soul, it was supposed that it could be established in the Catholic Church itself. The theistic evolutionists, one of whom was Carlo Colombo (who later became Paul VI's theologian!) appealed to "progress" of science which they used—we know not with what good faith—to turn hypotheses into absolute certainties.[8] The background to all of this is well described by Card. Ruffini:

> Through several Catholic circles there has spread the impression that the question of man's origin has recently received such encouraging results from paleo-anthropological research, that we are now obliged, for the sake of truth as well as of prudence, to cast aside our previous convictions based on the Bible, the doctrine of the Fathers of the Church, as well as the constant teaching of the Church.[9]

Unfortunately, the doctrine [or teachings] of the Fathers, even though carrying much weight, was not able, in this case, to settle the question once and for all.

Card. Ruffini, himself a cardinal member of the Pontifical Biblical Commission and zealous defender of the traditional and obvious meaning of Genesis chapter 2 (7-24), writes in one of his fundamental works on evolutionism[10] that there is lacking in the Fathers' teachings one of the two indispensable conditions for declaring that the creation of the human body from the slime of the earth be considered as belonging to the deposit of Faith. In fact, in order for the doctrine of the Fathers to be able to vouch for the divine and apostolic Tradition and testify therefore in favor of divine Revelation, it is necessary that: *1)* the Fathers show themselves unanimous (at least morally) to attest to a truth; *2)* they must attest to this truth as a truth of Faith, for

"Unfortunately, the doctrine of the Fathers, even though carrying much weight, was not able, in this case, to settle the question once and for all."

example, by declaring guilty of heresy anyone attacking it or else by affirming that such is indeed the teaching of the Church, or by any other equivalent way. As to the direct creation of the human body from the slime of the earth, we have the unanimous accord of the Fathers, but in their texts, there is lacking the second essential condition (with the exception of a doubtful text of St. Jerome) which explains the theologians' state of uncertainty in qualifying this doctrine (for some a "*de fide* truth," for others, simply a "common judgment").

This enabled theologians as well as authorized exegetes or those close to Pius XII, such as Boyer, Pirot, Ceuppens and Bea, to affirm that in the biblical narrative we must retain the fact (of God's special intervention in the creation of the human body) and leave it to science to determine the way in which it was done: that is, if God formed the human body from inorganic or organic matter (the latter being a nice way of saying: from an animal). In this case [*i.e.*, from an animal], "slime of the earth" in the biblical text would simply be understood in its figurative meaning, and not in its literal sense, as it has always been believed. Pirot, for example, had written:

> Whether God made use of the body of an animal to fashion the body of the first man (or not) remains a question to be addressed not by exegesis, but by (the science) of anthropology.[11]

And Ceuppens, another qualified exegete: "I think that both theories can be equally justified or defended."[12]

Also Bea, who at the time was the Rector of the Biblical Institute:

> This question belongs, as do many others, to that category of various problems which should constitute the object of research in the applied sciences of paleontology, biology and of morphology.[13]

Finally, Boyer, who was then professor (and then rector) at the Pontifical Gregorian University:

> They also exaggerate those who ...are most scandalized...by the idea that the founts of Revelation do not clearly exclude some kind of participation of some inferior living species in the fashioning of the first human body.[14]

These assertions of authorized persons gave rise to a great deal of negative reactions on the part of theologians and exegetes equally qualified in these matters.

It was at this juncture that Pope Pius XII intervened with his encyclical *Humani Generis* when he wrote:

> It remains for Us now to speak about those questions which, although they pertain to the positive sciences, are nevertheless more or less connected with the truths of the Christian Faith. In fact, not a few insistently demand that the Catholic religion take these sciences into account as much as possible. This certainly would be praiseworthy in the case of clearly-proven facts; but caution must be used when it is rather a question of hypotheses, having some sort of scientific foundation, in which the doctrine contained in Sacred Scripture or in Tradition is involved. If such conjectural opinions are directly or indirectly opposed to the

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doctrine revealed by God, then the demand that they be recognized can in no way be admitted.

For these reasons the Teaching Authority of the Church does not forbid that, in conformity with the present state of human sciences and sacred theology, research and discussions, on the part of men experienced in both fields, take place with regard to the doctrine of evolution, in as far as it inquires into the origin of the human body as coming from pre-existent and living matter—for the Catholic Faith obliges us to hold that souls are immediately created by God. However, this must be done in such a way that the reasons for both opinions, that is, those favorable and those unfavorable to evolution, be weighed and judged with all necessary seriousness, moderation and measure, and provided that all are prepared to submit to the judgment of the Church, to whom Christ has given the mission of interpreting authentically the Sacred Scriptures and of defending the Dogmas of Faith.

And at this point, as a note, Pius XII refers to his Allocution to the members of the Academy of Sciences (Nov. 30, 1941, AAS, vol. XXIII, 1941, p.506) wherein he had affirmed:

> The numerous research works in the fields of paleontology, of biology as well as in morphology on other problems concerning the origins of man have, to date, come up with nothing positively clear and certain. It behooves us, therefore, to leave to the future the answer to this question, if, perchance, science, enlightened and guided by Divine Revelation, is able to provide certain and definitive results (answers) on such an important question.

It is, therefore, a bit of an exaggeration to say that Pius XII had "already affirmed that there was no opposition between evolution and the doctrine of the Faith." It is, on the contrary, quite accurate to declare that in *Humani Generis*, the Roman Pontiff makes no pronouncement, leaving to the scientists and theologians the task of bringing forth arguments both pro and con, while reserving to the "judgment of the Church" the last word once they have finally obtained (if possible) "certain and definitive results." And it is still too much to have Pius XII say that "if the human body takes [*sic*] its origin from living, pre-existent matter, the spiritual soul is immediately created by God." Pius XII never used the present indicative tense, the tense of reality and of certitude, and never would have done so. What he did say, since he was only speaking hypothetically, was that even if the human body should have had its origin in an animal (which is still light years away from being a demonstrated fact) the immediate creation of the human soul would remain firm and unaltered.

In the same vein, it is stretching the truth to pretend that Pius XII "considered the doctrine of evolutionism as a serious hypothesis, worthy of research and of serious thought and this, just as much as its opposing hypothesis."

As a matter of fact, Pius XII does not say that theistic evolution is a serious hypothesis, but that it is a hypothesis to be studied with all "necessary earnestness (or seriousness)" (which is, quite obviously, not the same thing at all); he maintains that it is a hypothesis not "worthy" but "which needs" to be weighed and judged "with all necessary seriousness, moderation and measure" and that everyone is duty-bound to be submitted to the judgment of the Church. And lastly, it is too much to say that Pius XII considers the evolutionist hypothesis "worthy of research and of serious thought and this, just as much as its opposing hypothesis." In fact, right after this, Pius XII deplores the case where…:

> …some, however rashly, transgress this liberty of discussion (*i.e.*, that liberty of discussion allowed by *Humani Generis*), when they act as if the origin of the human body from pre-existing and living matter were already completely certain and proved by the facts which have been discovered up to now and by reasoning on those facts, and as if there were nothing in the sources of Divine Revelation which demanded the greatest moderation and caution in this question.

"In the same vein, it is stretching the truth to pretend that Pius XII 'considered the doctrine of evolutionism as a serious hypothesis'"

This last affirmation simply means that Pius XII does not at all consider theistic evolution "just as much as its opposing hypothesis" and that his obvious reservation of judgment on this question is rather more negative (*non-licet*) than positive.

1. Sermonti, who refers to his book La luna nel bosco (Rusconi,1985), is also the co-author with Roberto Fondo of the work Dopo Darwin-Critica all' evoluzionismo.
2. Cf. Osservatore Romano, Oct. 24, 1996.
3. La Nazione, Oct. 25, 1996.
4. Cf. Motu proprio Sedula Cura of Paul VI, art. 3.
5. Byrne, Ravasi etc. Cf. Si Si No No, Oct. 31, 1994.
6. Cf. Si Si No No, Dec. 31, 1994.
7. Enchiridion Biblicum no.338.
8. V. C. Colombo, "Trasformismo antropologico e teologia", La Scuola cattolica, 77 (1949), pp.17-43; on p.26 it is claimed that the theory of evolution belongs to science "as demonstrated facts and theories."
9. E. Ruffini in his article "Responsabilita dei paleoantropologi cattolici" in Osservatore Romano, June 3, 1950.
10. E. Ruffini, La teoria dell'Evoluzione secundo la scienza e la Fede, (Rome, Orbis Catholicus, 1948).
11. L. Pirot, Adam, Dict. de la Bible, Supplement, I, 1928.
12. P. F. Ceuppens, Le polygenisme et la Bible, Angelicum, 1947, p.27.
13. A. Bea in Biblica XXV(1944), p.77.
14. C. Boyer, De Deo creante, 1948, p.412.

The Traditional Mass and Carlism, a Paradox

Men Necessarily Are Born and Perfected Within the Political Communities to Which They Belong

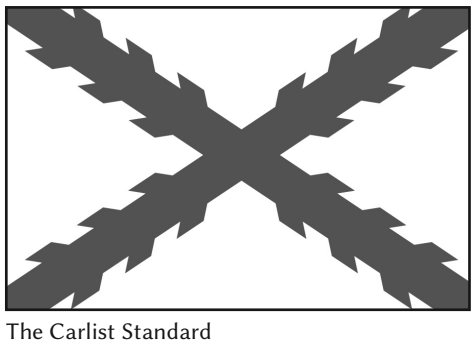
Carmen Giménez

Are laymen inferior clergy? Or is theirs a mission which is still Catholic but distinct from that of the Churchmen? The Carlist tradition is a rich one, and one that maintains a clear understanding of the role of the Catholic laymen, especially in how that role pertains to the wielding of the temporal sword for the sake of God's Kingdom amongst the nations. Our author, writing in our times, sheds light on these issues.

An error of conception continues to remain firmly entrenched in the mentality of numerous Catholics. Its particular persistence and unfortunate dissemination leads me to put these humble lines into writing. We therefore ask the reader to forgive the repetitions.

The fascination (certainly deserved) produced by the traditional Holy Mass, a hidden (rather, concealed) treasure, has apparently become somewhat blinding for some Catholics precisely because of how dazzling it is.

Recalling briefly some basic notions, we know that there exists the natural order, or the order of creation, and the supernatural order, or the order of grace. We know that the latter perfects the former; it builds upon it, but does not replace it. In addition to this, we know that men necessarily are born and perfected within the political communities to which they belong. The structure, organization, and government of these political communities play an absolutely decisive role in determining whether this perfection of their members can take place adequately—for which purpose they make use of sound institutions—or whether it becomes, if not absolutely impossible, extremely difficult.



The Carlist Standard

The model par excellence of a Christian social order is found in Christendom, which, as we know, "is neither something waiting to be invented nor something to be constructed in the clouds," but has had visible and tangible historical manifestations. It is worth considering here the position of those Catholics who, while recognizing that order as the objective toward which we should aspire, err in their choice of means by regarding as the key to success not action on the political plane, but an indefatigable promotion of the traditional Mass: the bulwark that will finally bring us —automatically—the return of Christendom, the restoration of the Christian social order.

Of course, we do not intend to question or relativize the capital importance of the Holy Mass, nor the necessity of grace for a civilization to be properly and stably ordered toward God. But we do wish to point out the deficiencies of the anti-political mentality that is often observed.

The first thing that should be mentioned about this conception is its evident confusion of planes. *A priori*, the fact that laymen work to achieve a political community that is an adequate means of the natural and supernatural perfection of its members is not something that depends upon the decisions of ecclesiastical hierarchies concerning liturgical matters, which properly belong to the clerical estate. That liturgical changes have seriously hindered the transmission of the Faith is a fact; but it is a fact that can never justify abandoning the good political struggle, which does not require the existence of such-and-such rubrics in order to take place.

For the necessity of the Catholic unity of the political community can be defended with arguments that proceed from the natural order, which is the necessary substratum for the action of grace. To limit oneself to the defense of liturgical tradition as the sole and exclusive bastion by which the conversion of societies will be achieved reveals an equivocal understanding, on the one hand, of the role that grace exercises over nature, and, on the other, of the reality that politics is the great temporal means by which the salvation of peoples is facilitated.

The promotion, through ecclesiastical documents, of the fostering of public worship of false religions within societies, and the defense of a hypothetical religious liberty that sets aside the rights of Christ the King and is incompatible with the Christian social order, ought to be a greater cause for protest and mobilization among Catholics, because they constitute a direct attack upon the natural order, over which Catholics themselves possess direct authority, than if the clergy were to prohibit the praying of the Holy Rosary overnight.

Faced with the eagerness of many clerics to catalyze the destruction of every vestige of that political tradition which gave structure to Christendom as the social and institutional embodiment of the Gospel, any layman of good will ought to receive the existence of a broad and impregnable sphere of action of his own in the task of restoring the Catholic City as a blessed piece of news.

The second point to emphasize is that, even if someone were to ignore the foregoing, the position we are examining collapses simply by taking a glance at the events that have occurred in Christendom and in Hispanic Christendom over the last two centuries. Christendom was dismantled without any assistance whatsoever from the liturgical reform; the latter was undertaken when the Revolution was already at a very advanced stage and, indeed, it has greatly hindered—together with the doctrinal ambiguities of the clergy —Catholic political action (and not merely political action, but even catechetical action in the broad sense).

"The fact that laymen work to achieve a political community that is an adequate means of the natural and supernatural perfection of its members is not something that depends upon the decisions of ecclesiastical hierarchies concerning liturgical matters."

In this regard, a brief observation: along these lines of abandoning political and catechetical work, it does not seem coincidental in recent times that there has been encouragement of a culture of public testimonies of "conversion" within Catholic circles, which in some way seems to seek to prove that this work is not, in the end, necessary "because God has His ways" and "the Holy Spirit finds a way through even the most adverse circumstances."

More than that, it seems to suggest that the abandonment of one's duties actually

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The Traditional Mass and Carlism, a Paradox Cont.

Continued from Page 7

leaves greater freedom for divine action in souls and in History. When in reality, not even such testimonies, nor those who promote them, are free from living, in some way, off the inheritance of what remained of a Catholic society in Spain until the last century.

In short, to obstinately think that the celebration of the traditional Mass can, in isolation and by itself, reverse the collapse of Christendom is senseless. It was the ensemble of modern errors (many of them deviations from the natural order with consequences for the supernatural order) that gave rise to a heresy which distanced nations and innumerable souls from the Church, long before the existence of the *Novus Ordo Missae*. The fierce struggle against those errors preserved Hispanic Christendom for longer. And subsequently, when its time came, its fracturing was due to concrete events carried out by concrete men, many of whom embraced liberal ideas while simultaneously attending the traditional Holy Mass every Sunday and holy day of obligation.

In this second part, going further, we believe it is relevant to recall that the men who proposed and ratified the casting aside of the traditional liturgy also celebrated exclusively the traditional Mass up to that point. This liturgical reform took place after the liberal revolutions and, to a certain extent, as a consequence of them. While it is indeed true that the reform accelerated and consolidated the social decline that followed, to claim that the traditional Roman rite, which by itself has not even been capable of defending itself against the errors of the age, will be capable of restoring Christendom while dispensing with a tenacious and sacrificial political action on the part of laymen in the temporal order is complete absurdity.

What we wish to express is that, just as the *pater familias* is not exonerated from his duty to provide sustenance for his offspring simply because he spends every morning kneeling in the parish church, the work of many laymen in defending and promoting the traditional Holy Mass, although necessary and meritorious, in no way dispenses them from their duties toward the Fatherland.

Rather, as Prof. José Miguel Gambra indicates, seeking that political restoration is precisely the best way to contribute, as laymen, to improving the ecclesial situation:

> "As a group whose purpose is political, all that remains to us is to return to the perennial teachings of the Church regarding political duties and, having overcome the scruples of servile obedience to the eccentricities of ecclesiastics, to promote the natural common good (an immense good in itself) and to prepare with the greatest possible commitment, as secondary causes that we are, the focus of resistance that may serve as our humble contribution to the providential action of God upon the world and upon our Fatherland. Because, at the same time, we shall serve as an extrinsic and indirect support for the recovery of order within the Church herself."



Parade of the Carlist Requeté during the Spanish Civil War.

Quite apart from this, in order to have a complete view of the situation, it is also necessary to ask: What exactly is the situation of the traditional Mass at this moment? Its defenders, depending on the bishop at whose feet they happen to fall, oscillate between the greatest contempt and, at best, tolerance clothed in the garb of a gracious concession.

The latter, moreover, is perceived as an act of magnanimous condescension which probably delights the conscience of the cleric in question. It is like the schoolmaster who, although deep down he is longing to expel the unruly and troublesome pupil from the classroom, knows that the true merit, the act of mercy, consists in patiently putting up with him in the hope of getting him to abandon his bad habits; while, naturally, trying to ensure that his peculiarities do not have repercussions upon others.

And for that to be possible, it is an elementary condition that they continue to constitute an overwhelming numerical minority. As a sad illustration, consider the example of a well-known Spanish church in which, recently, from one year to the next, the sacrament of Confirmation ceased to be offered according to the traditional rite, after the diocesan leadership perceived a worrying increase in the number of those interested in it.

We say the foregoing because we would not wish to conclude these lines without alluding to the objection par excellence (which, if not voiced, is at least thought) among those who, while sympathetic to liturgical tradition, disparage political tradition, given the striking nature of the reasoning underlying it.

Namely: that we are no longer at that point in history, and that the opportunity to achieve victory disappeared many decades ago; that the success of the Carlist Cause is so improbable that it would be better to save one's efforts and direct them toward some other enterprise.

> "Laymen cannot and must not wait for the clergy to resolve specific matters for which they have been divinely instituted before beginning to work for the restoration of the Christian social order"

To them, many of whom are tireless participants in initiatives defending liturgical tradition, one might ask: how exactly probable is it that the current ecclesiastical hierarchy, already almost entirely nurtured at the breast of the postconciliar era, mistress and master of the seminaries throughout the world, permeated with modernism, will suddenly decide that that tiny handful of rebellious sheep were right all along; that a reform of the reform must be undertaken, for which not even the greatest sympathizers of the old rite found the strength; and that they must reevaluate the manner in which they have understood and preached the Faith throughout their entire lives?

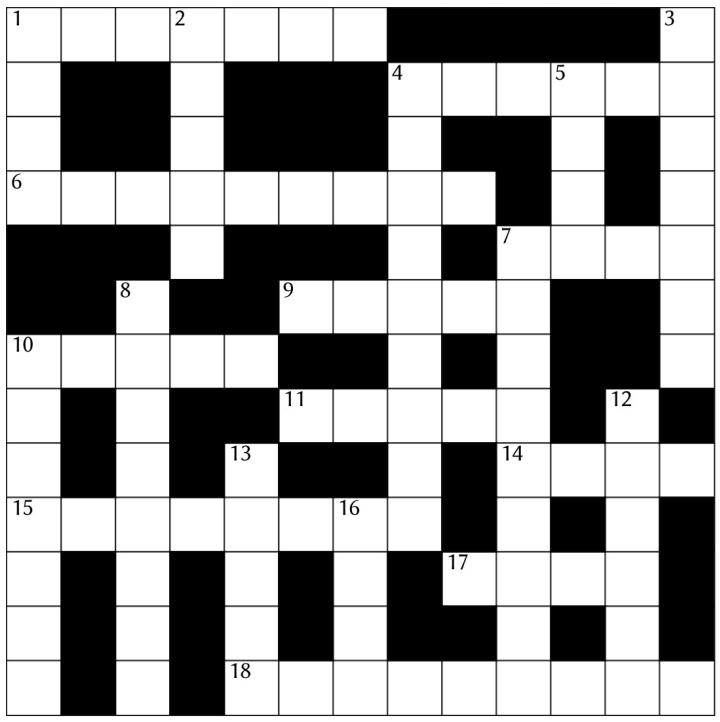
With these words, we do not seek to discourage the admirable champions of the traditional Holy Mass, from whose labors so many of us Catholics are benefiting. We are merely trying to make clear that, generally speaking, a cause is driven more greatly and effectively by the conviction of its unavoidable necessity than by subjective and human forecasts of success.

Laymen cannot and must not wait for the clergy to resolve specific matters for which they have been divinely instituted before beginning to work for the restoration of the Christian social order, for which —fortunately—they do not need the permission of any bishop.

The same wellspring of grace that inspired and sustained the great men of Christendom remains available to us. To assume that political action is irretrievably subordinated to a decision to reform the liturgy in one direction or another is to have failed to understand the distinction (which is not a separation) between the natural and supernatural orders; an erroneous and emasculating belief that strips the layman of his real agency to intervene in the course of historical events.

PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

CROSSWORD



Across

1) Name given to a baptised person who retains some of the faith but rejects other parts (7)
4) A Roman god (6)
6) An insatiable appetite for something (9)
7) Ale + Hops = ? (4)
9) A town in the north of Ireland, sometimes prefixed with London- (5)
10) We aspire to the _____ of Christ the King (5)
11) First letter of the Greek alphabet (5)
14) A Roman emporer (4)
15) Word meaning "praise the Lord" (8)
17) River flowing into the Mediterranean (4)
18) What might be hung on a Christmas tree (9)

Down

1) Greek word for round disk, saints are said to have one of these (4)
2) We must respect our _____s. (5)
3) One of the three evangelical counsels (7)
4) Greek word for those writings proposed to enter the Christian Canon but rejected on grounds of inauthenticity (9)
5) Worn on some liturgical vestments as a trim (4)
7) One of the eastern rites of Holy Mass (9)
8) Relating to the sparsely populated mountainous areas of Scotland (8)
10) French, Spanish and Italian are examples of _____ languages (7)
12) Latin word meaning 'east' (6)
13) Famous Greek philosopher, author of many dialogues (5)
16) Greek word meaning image, also the same word to describe a type of sacred art from the east (4)

CALTROP SWEEPER

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Backbiters Get Their Due

Perennial Words From The Middle Ages

St. Bernardine of Siena

From Sermons of St. Bernardine of Siena, *published in 1920. St Bernadine himself gave the sermon around 1427. He reformed the morals of Siena with his public preaching, which was then common amongst the mendicant orders. This great saint was contemporary with others including both St Colette and St Vincent Ferrer.*

Oftimes the backbiter goeth about with a show of kindness and speaketh evil of others. He walketh under the shadow of a fair manner, seeming possessed of charity, and malice lurketh beneath. Knowest thou what he doth resemble? He is like to an ulcer, and outwardly he is glossed over, and such men as these when they wish to hide their malice do after this fashion; ere they speak of a thing they send before an ambassador. And knowest thou who this ambassador is? They send forth a sigh, O, o! What aileth thee, eh? What is it? O, o, I have a great melancholy upon me! And then he will begin and will say: Brother, what I am about to say, I will say for a good purpose, God knoweth it (and he giveth him the sure token), in faith I wish to tell it thee. Such an one hath done such and such a thing. Meseems that such another is doing a certain wrong, in my opinion. He doeth this or that, and to me it doth appear that he hath the wish to do thus and thus. And he will say very many things, and in all these he will lie in his throat. This evil tongue that doth in this way is like to the scorpion, which doth perform three things, and all maliciously. First, it licketh with its tongue; second, it encircleth with its claws, third, with its tail it doth twist it, and lift it into the air, and then it doth bite. In this samemanner doth the backbiter do.

Thus such a backbiter may be likened to the serpent which is called the basilisk. This serpent which I tell you of is so poisonous that if it touches a spring of water at once this is wholly dyed and infected, so deadly is its poison. In like manner doeth the evil tongue, for with its wicked speech it can at once poison a city, a country, a province.

If thou seest that another doth evil, correct him not with a slandering tongue, but with a kind manner, as the Church hath taught thee. There are very many who see no other evil than that which their neighbour doth perform. Art thou here, thou who seest no wrongdoing but that of others? Pay heed to that which the Gospel saith when it telleth thee that thou seest the mote in the eye of thy neighbour and seest not the beam in thine own. And therefore I say to these, see to it that thou dost correct thine own defect, and so thou wilt do better than if thou dost correct others while thou thyself remainest in sin. O women, to what are ye bound? Know ye what? Both that ye shall perform good and that ye shall give good example.

And to give good example belongeth most of all to the priest, rather than to any other person, as thou hast it in the Decretals; and I say that the priest doth more grievous wrong by giving bad example merely by scandalizing his neighbour by a wicked life, than if a layman were to go out to rob in the highway. The reason is this; that he who standeth in the highway doth rob the man who passeth by, and doth take from him his money, his horse, his garments, and all that which he findeth, but the other with his evil example doth make away with both soul and body of the man whom he doth scandalize thereby, and leaveth him to say and to do evil and to commit sin.

Knowest thou that which thou shouldst do? Do as I shall tell thee, and lay up this example in thy memory. A man seteth out to sea, and there are in one and the same boat father and sons, the wife, brothers, and servants, all of one household. And when they are thus out at sea, there cometh a tempest so violent that it dasheth the ship against a rock. The ship is wholly shattered: at once everyone endeavoureth to save himself, one upon a log, one upon a plank. There are tiny children, there are elder ones of five years, of ten, of twenty years; and so everyone doth aid himself as far as he is able. There will be one child who will say to his father: O my father, help me! For if thou helpst me not, I shall drown; help me, for I can hold out no longer! And the father, methinks, would reply: Child, help thyself, for I have so great difficulties in helping myself, that more is beyond me; for the father knoweth that if he attempt to go to the aid of his son, they will both perish. And therefore lay up this example in thy heart: wish not to practise such rashness; busy not thyself so much about the deeds of others. Doh! Hast thou heard that any man increaseth his substance who doth busy himself about the affairs of others? Not I, in faith! And therefore I say, do that which concerneth thee. And the wise man speaketh no evil of the deeds of others, instead for sooth he even saith little about his own concerns. And he who is a natural and an upright man seeketh ever to correct his own evil practices and doth not sift the intentions of others.

Gregory gives us the example of a backbiter, which is a very excellent one, and saith that he is like a man who hath a heap of dust; and the wind bloweth against him and he hath his eyes turned towards the dust in such a way that it bloweth into his eyes, and his eyes are filled with dust, because he looked at naught else but at that heap. And then he can see clearly neither his own deeds nor the deeds of others.

> "Thus such a backbiter may be likened to the serpent which is called the basilisk… for with its wicked speech it can at once poison a city, a country, a province."

The cursed slandering tongue is raging mad. Knowest thou how it is made? It is made like the mad dog, and knowest thou how the mad dog doth? What doth he do? He holdeth his mouth open, he hath a bloody mouth, all inflamed with rage from biting. The open mouth doth signify that he ever speaketh evil, and that he speaketh at most times when he should be silent, and that oftimes he is silent when he should speak; and this is the habit and condition of the raging backbiter. He hath a bloody mouth, because their delight is ever in devouring blood and raw flesh. Such as these may be likened to those curs who stand about the shop of a butcher, who when they see a strange dog coming, run all together towards him and sniff at him, and by his smell they know that he is not one of them. When they have found out this they begin presently to snarl and to show their teeth; and when he beginneth to bark all these curs rush upon him and one doth bite him here and one doth bite him there, in such wise that he is all torn by their; and so they chase him away, saying: Thou art not one of us. They do not thus when one of their own goeth there; then how they sniff him, and caress him, knowing that he is one of their slandering companions, and it doth seem as if they would say, one to another: He is one of us. And though he be not known to them all, that one who knoweth him saith: Come, stop here, for thou art one of us, do that which thou shouldst do.

And know thou that whosoever hath this vice, his mouth stinketh, and learn, O, ye women, and ye also, men, that the stench of such as these may be likened to the stench of wells; for thou seest a well that sendeth forth a stench from its mouth, and such is theirs; their stench is in their mouths. And therefore see that every time thou hearest one of these who speaketh

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A coin minted in honour of this great saint

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

North American Wife: Edith

Greetings Editor,

I think having a 'Letters to The Editor' section in your newspaper is brilliant. I have very much enjoyed reading them in the past issues (and wish they were more common!). Whilst majority of your readership is in all likelihood male, I, as a wife and mother thoroughly enjoy your content (perhaps some of the more 'masculine' topics require a bit more concentration on my part) and I especially get excited when I see articles speaking about women, motherhood and femininity. How much modern society lacks the latter! Hence, how much I endeavour to fill the void (and rather imperfectly in my frailty), at least in our circles of influence. I like to imagine there are other women out there reading these feminine articles from *The Plough* and doing so in like manner. It gives me hope and encouragement. How funny to think a little newspaper from the other side of the world has the ability to connect souls in this way. A little monthly boost I can squeeze into the busy schedule. If I may be so bold as to request the continuation, where the editor sees fit, of a feminine article every so often—I am sure it also must help men to see the womanly ideal, rather than the ever present feminists! (I best be careful writing the word 'feminist', as if I am free from harbouring some of the vices found therein.) What a pleasure to read your work, thank you and God bless.

(NB. So as not to cause scandal, this letter was written with the approval and over-sight of my loving husband.)

Thank you for your letter, Edith.

As encouraging as it is for you to read this publication, it is equally encouraging for me to receive your letter.

"Who shall find a valiant woman? Far and from the uttermost coasts is the price of her."

What words from Holy Scripture! You are right: The Plough is more oriented towards men, as, being the leaders and agents of the public sphere, it is they whom God uses to Christianise the inter-family space.

The reason there is usually an article on a feminine topic in each issue is twofold. Firstly, it is to edify and build up those female readers who are thirsty for the true wisdom and doctrine of the Church on these matters. How badly we need this in these confusing times! Such wisdom is hard to come by today.

Secondly, I think it is useful for male readers, perhaps particularly single men, to understand what type of qualities they should be looking for in a wife. Now, no one is perfect, and one cannot expect to marry a ready-made saint; nonetheless, it is important for a man to have his compass set in the right direction when searching for a marriage partner.

May both man and woman profit!

God bless you!

Please visit www.theplough.ink/contribute to send a letter in.

Backbiters Get Their Due Cont.



One section of an altar triptych featuring St Bernadino

Continued from Page 9

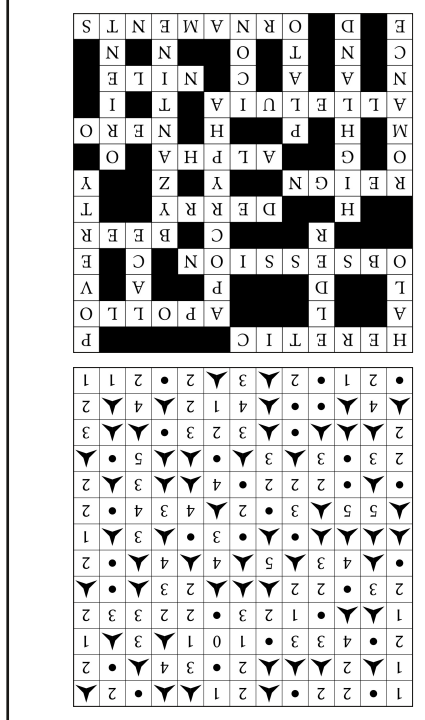
evil of others, as soon as thou hearest him, close thy nose and do so, and say: Oh, how he stinks! And if he continue with his speech continue thou too with thine, and turn thyself away, and say: Oh, he stinks with a fearful stench! Retiring thyself a little. And do ye so, children; forget not whensoever you hear someone who speaketh evil of people at once to close your noses and say: Oh, how he stinks! And if you do this, never will the stench of anything wicked come to you. And I wish you to know this, that because they stink the fact is that when they find themselves together they do not seem to one another stinky. Dost thou ask the reason of this? If there be gathered together one hundred who all stink, the stench is great among them; so that if one or two more should come, it doth not seem to them as if the stench were greater than before, for they stink so much among themselves that they do not perceive the stench of others.

Such men as these may be likened to the hedgehog, which stinks by its nature. I mean not the chestnut-burr, I speak of the hedgehog, which doth throw itself upon the grapes, and which hath quills so sharp that as often as it doth roll itself over the grapes, it is all covered with them, and so doth carry them away. Of which hedgehog I say that it doth emit a foul odour from either end.

He is also like to the lion whose mouth is foul; and as the lion devoureth creatures, so doth the backbiter; with his words he killeth everyone. And therefore it is said: *Susceperunt me sicut leo paratus ad praedam.* They have poisoned me like as doth the lion ready to spring upon his prey. And such a one as this spreadeth infection throughout the world, and poisoneth every creature who doth hear the backbiter if he be not aware and be not upon his guard.

Backbiters devour, because to speak evil of others is to devour. O, women, have ye never broken the fast of Lent? Have ye never eaten meat on Friday or Saturday, or the eve of the day commanded by the Church to be kept holy? Saith this woman: No, God knoweth I have never eaten it. Thou liest in thy throat, for thou hast eaten it many a time, and hast eaten it raw, in thy cruelty. Hast thou slandered anyone? Yes. And whom hast thou slandered? It was a man. A man hast thou eaten. O I slandered a priest. A priest hast thou eaten. I slandered a bishop. A bishop hast thou devoured. I slandered a cardinal. A cardinal hast thou devoured. I slandered the Pope. The Pope thou hast devoured. And thou, a nun; a nun hast thou devoured; and thou, thy neighbour; thy neighbour hast thou devoured.

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS



Rewards and Punishment

A Gentle Balance?

Anonymous Capuchin

From the work Mother Love *authored by an anonymous Capuchin brother in 1888.*

A stubborn evil spirit that resists the ordinary means of control is driven out, according to the words of our Lord, by prayer and fasting. This is also the means by which deeply-rooted defects and faults in children must be driven out. Prayer and fasting will win. Still as long as a child is young enough to be coerced, it should be compelled to pray and fast in its own behalf, though it may be good and advisable that a mother pray for such a child and offer for it many personal acts of self-denial. Prayer humbles the spirit, while fasting chastens the flesh and is the sovereign remedy against sensuality.

This two-fold means is indicated in all cases which do not yield to admonitions and remonstrances, nor to kind words or threats. The mother should consider the source of the fault—pride or sensuality—and choose the remedy accordingly. But she should remember that prayer alone, though very efficacious, will not in itself subdue a proud spirit. It is also necessary to make the child feel humiliation. This may be done by showing preference to its brothers and sisters, by being brief and curt, by disregarding its advances, by isolating it from the others, and by other such minor humiliations.

Repeated faults of sensuality are most easily conquered by denying a child a dessert or some delicacies and knick-knacks for which it may have a special predilection; in extreme cases, some favorite dish or necessary food may also be denied. In serious breaches of sensuality, the child should be compelled to sleep on a hard, springless bed, or some other physical chastisement be administered with the palm of the hand or with the rattan or rod. Hardness of heart against the poor should be conquered by distributing alms to the needy through the hand of the child, avarice and greed may be corrected by depriving the child of things to which it may be much attached and by insisting upon its sharing liberally with its brothers and sisters whatever it possesses. The same means, namely distributing alms through the hands of the child and denial of the comforts and luxuries of life, may be used when the child is inclined to extravagance.

The choice of the particular punishment to be administered in the individual case must be a subject of intelligent study. A mother's intention must never be merely the infliction of pain, but rather the amendment of the child. Severe punishments should only be resorted to when light punishments produce no results. The punishment, also, which was fixed upon, should never be applied more severely than necessary, and it should always be administered with due regard for the child's physical condition.

Frequent mistakes are made in the choice and infliction of chastisement. They are mostly administered without reflection, on the spur of the moment and thoughtlessly. On one occasion, parents will punish excessively, and on another not enough, or not at all. Would to God that every mother and every father understood the value of conscientious punishment! The punishment of children has for its object the correction and amendment of faults, and if it is to produce these results, parents must consider it one of their most important obligations, the faithful fulfillment of which becomes a source of untold benefit to their boys and girls and also the occasion of infinite merits to themselves.

However, it is not sufficient to inculcate merely a fear of sin in the hearts of children by the infliction of some punishment; parents must also instill in them a love of virtue for its own sake and for the sake of the joys and rewards attached to the practice of virtue. This may be done by portraying to them the inner peace which is consequent upon the doing of good works in the service of God and of our neighbor, and by describing in some appropriate story the unrest and remorse of conscience which the sinner experiences after his misdeeds.

Parents should not be chary of words of commendation and encouragement when a child perseveringly strives to get rid of some fault, or when it has performed some act of self-denial, of patience, of kindness, of obedience, or of forgiveness, which perhaps required no little moral courage. Indeed, mother and father should show sincere pleasure in any act of virtue that the child might perform, and at times, even reward it with some material recompense. Still, in doing so, they should remind the child of the greater pleasure which God has in its well-doing, and how He will reward it with the eternal happiness of His own heavenly home, if it will only persevere in its efforts till the end of its days.

Valuable presents and extraordinary pleasures should rarely be given as a reward. Trifling gifts and minor enjoyments may be granted, but not too frequently, otherwise the child may learn to despise them. The child should never join in the amusements proper to adults only, neither should it be drawn into their cares and worries. The longer we can preserve in the children the simplicity and the innocence of childhood, the more shall we be able also to preserve in them the spirit of docility and obedience and their love for the simple pleasures of home-life.



Mother gathering fuel with her children.

Hospice for Health and Vigor

An Anecdote of Revitalisation

Ross McKnight

Our author share with us a personal story of his experience of the difference between the two perspectives of Catholic life and worship.

I think one of the core underpinnings of the arguments between what some call "traditional" Catholics and another segment of the church—known, at times, as "mainstream" Catholics or "Novus Ordo" Catholics—is the real difference in what one or the other group demands in terms of lifestyle and virtue in order to credentialize someone as a mouthpiece for Catholicism.

I hope that this little reflection will provide some intellectual *hors d'oeuvres* rather than just another basis for conflict between these two—broad—groups. I certainly acknowledge that the ideas I'm going to put forward will be a little uncomfortable and perhaps a little provocative for some, but this self-examination is necessary for a body to determine who he is and where he stands in order to move forward.

For myself, I would probably fall into the first category … the traditional Catholic group … again, in broad terms. I was raised in the mainstream, and went to Novus Ordo masses up until the age of 28.

Knowing myself perhaps better than anyone, barring my Creator, I can see quite clearly now the gap or the void or the discord between what it was that God seemed to demand from me (tremendous self-gift, penance, prayer, contemplation, sacrifice, the ongoing struggle for virtue) and what the Church, on the other hand, was demanding from me in practice.

It was possible to be just like everyone else in the world all week long, check boxes on Sundays and Holy days of obligation and in regard to the sacraments, and not necessarily consider much else. I don't mean to say that I did not, during this period of my life, have a Catholic conscience, Catholic awareness, a means of analyzing my experience in the world *vis-a-vis* the Faith, but there were few examples of Catholic leaders in my community to reify that strict encounter with Reality.

Conversations with fellow Catholics were not necessarily about the Faith, the Church, the works that the Church ought to be doing in the world—the necessity of fighting for the restoration of the Christian social order, for example, which is the role of the laity—but rather those conversations could be about football, food—any number of topics that are pleasant enough, but which, when repeated without the interruption of significant connection on subjects that speak to the heart of our being—being as Catholics—become hollow, insubstantial, and then seem to draw evermore into the spotlight that void, that gap, that Great Discrepancy between the Profession of Faith and the lives lived in and through every little act.

From a very consistent policy of immodesty (and I don't just mean flagrant self-exposition, but also a lack of decorum in dress), irreverence (not universal, but frequent), superficiality, vanity, chumminess—and generally the possibility of appearing to be both in and of the world—to a sad, perfunctory (dare I say "profane"?) liturgy attended by music that lifted my mind not to God but directed it to wonder whom the cantor might be today—there, again, the gap, the void, the Great Discrepancy.

I wouldn't dare say that there were not opportunities to go to lectures, Parish missions, etc. In fact, there was a great emphasis on "ministries" (rightly considered "apostolates" or "lay auxiliary" groups) in the parish I grew up in. In my mind, however, there was not a one-to-one match between holy men and women whom I could identify in the parish as having true devotion and those who were heavily involved in what we often term "Parish Life".

There was, on the one hand, a tremendous amount of busyness and work and activity, and, on the other, a few quiet souls before their God.

I am not going to cite statistics. This is a personal reflection, not an essay, but we all know how poorly they reflect upon the model I have just described.

In fact, by analogy, I myself "apostatized" from the performative version of Catholicism in which I was raised.

This whole conflict within myself, of course, came to a head during the beer-virus circus.

It became quite clear who had the Faith of the apostles and martyrs—and who did not.

I realize the above statement will hurt. I realize this statement may alienate some. I am prepared for that. I won't lie and say I do not still carry some bitterness myself. The treatment of the laity by the hierarchy, by priests, by deacons, by lay officials at parishes—this wound I and others may carry for the rest of our lives.

So I "apostatized".

I left the act.

I looked for authenticity.

I found it.

In fact, beside the height, holiness, ancientry, solemnity, and mystery of the liturgy of my fathers who fought and died before me to defend Christendom, worldliness in my peers became easier to bear. Worldliness in myself became less bearable.

I could not remain as I was. The law of prayer forbade it. There had to be war.

And that war continues. Now. It is in myself. It is against the world. It is raging continuously, raging with the kind of rage that is somehow peace, that is somehow conviction, that is somehow great love, that is somehow restorative, that makes my heart so high … so high—that gives me a sense of Honor, of purpose, of Hope—hope against hope, hope against insurmountable odds and the most formidable and powerful of foes. I can see the entire West laid bare and barren and see, at the same time, Victory inside of that despair.

Emotion is not everything, but it is not nothing, and the un-delved chambers of my heart now open lead only to deeper chambers wanting only the will of the delver—hence the war.

This is just my experience, my testimony—not much of an argument for the intellectually-inclined.

But I will say that, in the things that really matter, there is no cafeteria here, no picking and choosing. We on "the spectrum" of traditional Catholcism are often on the receiving end of cheap shots concerning the laws of obedience. Is this not how it must be? That, if we cling desperately to Christ and lose our homes and our friendships and our reputations because of it—such is the obedience to God rather than men?

I must not choose error knowingly, because I love He who is Truth.

If Mary-like standards of modesty, for example, are not a matter of contention, for the most part, because they are considered rather an assumption in the Catholic Tradition, think how difficult it is for us to hear the criticisms of those who, in immodesty of thought and of body and of speech, condemn us for our love.

If the words of Saint Paul are acknowledged as binding.

If the quiet dignity of a priest points to the ontological reality.

If we do not associate with the vowed enemies of Christ.

If we choose, rather, to fight for our own side, which is the Mystical Body of Christ, which is the Church and what She has always taught from the beginning.

If we grab hold of this: that what was once considered holy and honorable must always be so—this in accord with the indefectibility of the Church.

May God give us unity in the Truth.

This and more can found at:
rossjmcknight.substack.com





NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome, dear Reader, to the thirteenth issue of The Plough.

This is the month of October, which features that relatively new, but no less solemn, Feast of Christ the King. How wise Pope Pius XI was to institute such a feast for our times!

Part of the revolutionary strategy of the enemies of the Church, visible and invisible, is to destroy God by destroying those images of Him. The Russian Tsar, murdered by Bolsheviks. The King of France, put before the guillotine. These almost ritualistic killings serve a twofold purpose: to remove a particular person from authority today, but also to remove the idea of authority from the world tomorrow. Slowly, man has come to see every type of fatherhood destroyed: bishops are now ruled by conferences, fathers are ruled by their wives and children, and countries are ruled by "democracy."

The challenge for us today is to rebuild these images of God, which are the very reflections of God Himself. That means, particularly for men, taking your place as a father, as God's representative, in whatever sphere He has placed you. But not only that; we also need to consider deeply whether or not He intends to put us in charge of a larger sphere, be it the priesthood or perhaps a larger responsibility in the social affairs of our homelands.

I will be praying much for these graces this month.

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you,

The Editor of The Plough



Mr McKnight is an expert woodworker and carpenter, hailing from Louisiana .

The Agricultural Village

Idealistic or Neccesary?

H. Robbins

The Cross and Plough *was a distributist newsletter published in England in the early to mid 20th century. This article comes from a 1947 issue, where one of the oft-discussed topics was regarding how to integrate young English veterans back into civil society.*

You are, probably, the normal sort of human being in whom an idea evokes an image. Being this normal sort of person, if you think of England—not the England of which most of us have cause to be ashamed—but the England you are overworking, or fighting, or dying to preserve and recreate: then the image which will arise first in your mind is almost certainly the image of an English village.

For the village is the very genius of England, and this is not rhetoric but sober truth. It stands for England not only in the mind of the villager, but in the mind of the fighting industrial townsman as he longs for home: even the Cockney has this concept. For no one familiar with working London can be unaware of the exciting paradox that by very reaction from its hugeness London has taken on many of the attributes of a congeries of villages. (This by the way.)

The village is not planned, but it follows always a plan emerging from the ultimate reality it serves. Its houses are partly from the full flood of the tradition—these are mostly past their best—and partly from an age which was invariably deplorable in its building. It is the considerable achievement of the village to have digested all but the worst of these. It has a few larger dwellings on its outskirts, which will be a proof that even the Tudor and Stuart millionaires could not achieve ugliness. Its inn has a temperature well above that of the brewery company which has tried to impose its frigid urban efficiency. Its village hall is probably the village eyesore—proof of a living spirit which lacked its ancient means. Its church is certainly the loveliest thing in it. (I apologize to my unknown colleague for mentioning the Church. It is a comfort to reflect that writing his own article he is probably unable to refrain from mentioning the land.) But the Church. It is probably the key to our problem, and has evoked the same image a hundred times, that what is broad-based upon the living earth must point to heaven if it is to keep its soul.

No architect designed this village. No architect has ever equalled the achievement of its humble builders. For the village is an effect and not a cause. It is organic and functional—living and having its being in the life of the land.

This must be our explanation of survival and our key to the future. The village, battered, starved and abused, has survived because it is essential to the only thing stronger than industrialism. Nothing in the recent *Scott Report* [a government report] was so admirable as its appreciation and insistence that the English landscape, including the English village, is a consequence of the work of the English on the land, and that it cannot be preserved or recreated if that work suffers radical change.

Many testimonies converge. Mr. Peter Drucker, that strong thinker, has written recently The Future of Industrial Man. Significantly, it is chiefly about the past of non-industrial man. He lays down the undoubted truth that the modern strains and disintegration arise from the fact that "Western society is still fundamentally pre-industrial in its social beliefs and values"—whereas "decisive power is derived from no one but the managers themselves, controlled by nobody and responsible to no one."

Pre-industrial beliefs and values created the village. It follows that they must survive and flourish for the village to survive and flourish.

We arrive at this starting point for the future, only to realise with a shock that most of our Planners are trying to revive the villages by giving them as many urban (and worse, suburban) values as possible. One would have thought that the achievements of industrialism, at all events for the village, would have been a warning rather than an example. For if, as we must assume, the function of the village is to make villagers happy, the standards of happiness achieved in industrial towns by industrial means are—to use a remarkable understatement—at least irrelevant.

Our Planners, however, have ordered the attendant goblins to provide "a bumper of the same, for Mr. Grub."

Let us keep to the point. An English village is the result, not the cause, of a way of life and a habit of mind. If we want such villages, we must revive that way and habit.

It was the chief mark of the men who built the villages that they were yeomen owning, or at least controlling effectively, land in small units with a high degree of self-sufficiency. If we are to restore anything like what we understand by a village, farms must tend to become not larger but smaller, not specialised but mixed, not mechanised but rich in animal husbandry.

It does not matter whether you like this prospect or not. If you want villages you must have this basis for them. Only so will you revive the rich local life—the blacksmith, wheelwright, saddler and carpenter as well as the farmer—all contributing their characteristic quota to the community soul which produced this supreme thing.

Now, free and prosperous men on and about the land will certainly improve the villages. Free and prosperous men always cherish the good estate of their womenfolk and children.

But it does not follow that they will want to do it in a way characteristic (and no doubt necessary) in large towns. They will certainly want good water, for example. But it is by no means certain that they will want it piped from a dozen miles away, and perhaps not piped at all. Wells are congenial to the rural condition. All we have forgotten is that they need, not only sinking, but cleaning. Here is another rural craft which flourished once and has gone with the rural decay. Nor do I think it certain that a free village would choose to be lighted by an electric supply whose pylons affront the day.

They might even decide that Hollywood and Elstree films have no appeal for them. And they might decide that many special pleasures depend on the building of a village hall comparable in loveliness and dignity to the village church.

In the Middle Ages, of course, the nave of the church was thought suitable for many village functions which would shock us in such a site today. Well and good. They will in that case tear down the hideous wooden hut which was all their poverty afforded, and erect a seemly place, probably next to the Inn.

I do not know. No one can be sure until we have the free men in their little holdings. All I am insisting on here is that we are starting at the wrong end if we begin by reconstructing villages as much on the lines of the nearest large town as possible.

We are back to origins.

Let us begin with the first things. Let us not, as a wise old friend said to me recently, in our anxiety remove the physical stress from life, replace it with a psychological stress which will complete the ruin, among other ruins, of the English village.

Two practical dangers clamour for remedy.



A Yorkshire dale: such a scene evokes a deep reaction within the heart of an Englishman.

> "For the village is an effect and not a cause. It is organic and functional—living and having its being in the life of the land."

The great town has damned itself. It is proposed to disperse industry into the countryside. I express no opinion on the propriety of that course so far as small towns are concerned. That is not my function here. But unless industry can be decentralised to a point where it could take on again, and take happily, the quality of craftsmanship, it would be a disaster to extend industry to the village. It simply will not fit into that social unit as we know and value it. Not only would it affront the countrymen who through a century of inconceivable economic oppression and cultural hardships, have kept the villages alive. It would complete the destruction of the village spirit.

The other danger is complementary. The huge mechanised farms which are being advocated in many furtive quarters would destroy irrevocably that rich and diverse life of the village which depends for its validity on the intimate interplay of many strong characters formed by strong crafts. The best we could expect under such a system would be a succession of rural Bournvilles; and the most sympathetic member of the Cadbury family would hardly claim that Bournville was recognisable as a village.

At worst, we might be faced with the squalor of the huge monocultural estates of the Southern United States, or an arable wilderness hideous with the gyrotiller by day and abandoned with the time siren for the nearest town by night. (It is, of course, quite untrue that mechanised agriculture produces more food per acre. The contrary is true. Small units produce more per acre. The large produce less with fewer men.)

We can have any sort of government we deserve. We cannot have any type of economic layout we desire, for the material order is conditioned by the natural asset. We have forgotten two things of decisive importance. Industrialised methods have so eroded and exhausted the soils of the world that the period of easy food from the ends of the earth has gone for ever.

And industrialism has invaded so wantonly the world's stocks of irreplaceable raw materials that the period of imposed retrenchment is well in sight.

Add to these two enormous facts that as Mr. Walter Elliot reminded us in *The Times*, we must be prepared for Africa, Asia and Russia to go industrial on the scale of sixty percent of their populations.

It follows that the future of England is on the land. It follows that the accumulated soil fertility which we owe to the prudence of our ancestors is now England's capital asset. It follows that we must remember peasantries have always been conservators of soil fertility; and *latifundia*, everywhere and always, exhaustive of it.

And it follows that if we wish our Commonwealth indeed to last for a thousand years, we also must clear our minds of cant. We must see things stark, scrap the prejudices and fashions of a lifetime, and bring into being that race of small English farmers which alone can act in conformity with the conditions imposed upon us. If we do this, we shall achieve our finest hour. Certainly we shall bequeath intact to the future the good England seen from the Village Green.